

StageMic

User Manual

Version 1.18

Mic plots. Backstage handovers. Live crew displays.

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General

About StageMic

Mic plots, backstage handovers and live crew displays for theatre.

StageMic helps you plan who wears each radio mic throughout a show, then gives your backstage team a live view of the changes they need to make.

Run StageMic on your computer and open its backstage displays in a browser on an iPad, phone or laptop. No separate display app is required.

Plan your show

Create your scenes, characters and actors, then allocate numbered mics scene by scene.

Three plot views show the same allocations from different perspectives:

- **Mic plot:** follow each physical mic through the show.
- **Character plot:** see which mic each character wears.
- **Actor plot:** see each actor’s allocations, including actors playing multiple characters.

StageMic detects handovers between wearers and highlights conflicting allocations. When multiple mics are intentional, you can approve the allocation without removing either mic from the plot.

Support your backstage team

Backstage displays follow the scene selected on the controlling computer. They show the handovers for that scene, with actor names prominent, and the current mic allocations.

Crew can mark handovers completed, sharing their progress across connected displays and the control app. Optional alerts can warn the operator when advancing from a scene with handovers still unticked.

Follow show control

Scenes can be selected manually or controlled over OSC. StageMic works alongside QLab or other software capable of sending compatible OSC messages.

StageMic manages the allocation plan and handover information. It does not control radio transmitters, receivers or audio levels.

Share your plot

Print plots and backstage swap lists, produce individual actor reports, export CSV files or copy tables into an email.

Shows are saved locally as `.mic` files, with automatic saving of the current show.

Built from theatre experience

StageMic was conceived and directed by a solo developer, with features shaped by practical theatre experience. AI assisted with interface design, coding and automated testing. The app has received extensive testing by the developer, both during live shows and through simulated show scenarios.

Work together

Collaboration lets other licensed StageMic computers connect to a host on the same local network. The host approves each remote and chooses whether it may edit the show, manage completions and swap notes, or control scenes. The host keeps the shared show, serves backstage displays and receives OSC.

Plan offstage wearers and DCAs

Offstage markings distinguish people who retain a mic while offstage without changing allocations or handovers. The DCA plot lets you plan which characters belong to each numbered DCA in each scene. It is a programming reference; StageMic does not send DCA assignments to a console.

Open Character Mic History to follow one character's mics, or export a separate Pre-show Collection List with paper checkboxes for your performances.

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System Requirements

StageMic runs on a controlling computer. Backstage displays run in web browsers on devices connected to that computer over a local network.

Controlling computer

The current version requires:

Platform	Operating system
macOS	macOS 13 Ventura or later
Windows	Windows 10 or later, 64-bit

These operating-system requirements follow the Electron runtime used by StageMic v1.18.

Download a build appropriate for your computer’s processor. Availability of Intel, Apple silicon and Windows ARM builds depends on the downloads provided for that release.

StageMic does not require QLab, an audio interface or a connection to your radio mic system.

Backstage display devices

Backstage displays can be opened on:

- iPads and other tablets.
- iPhones and other smartphones.
- Mac, Windows and other laptops or desktop computers.

Use an up-to-date browser with JavaScript and cookies enabled. Safari, Chrome, Edge and Firefox are suitable browsers to try.

Display devices do not need StageMic installed or a separate StageMic licence.

The controlling computer must remain running with StageMic open while backstage displays are in use.

Network connection

The controlling computer and backstage devices must be on a network that allows them to communicate.

Wi-Fi, Ethernet or a combination of both can be used. Guest networks and networks with client isolation may prevent connections, even when devices appear to be on the same Wi-Fi.

Internet access is not required for communication between StageMic and its backstage displays.

Internet access and licensing

An internet connection is required for:

- Initial licence activation.
- Any online check-in required by your licence.
- Starting each new trial session.
- Online licence-management actions, including deactivation.

A paid licence with a valid offline allowance can start StageMic without an internet connection. Once a valid show session has started, losing internet access does not interrupt it.

See Licences and Activation and Trial Licences.

OSC control

OSC control requires software or hardware capable of sending supported OSC messages over UDP.

QLab can run on the same computer as StageMic or on another computer with a network connection to it. Other OSC controllers can also be used.

See QLab Integration and the OSC Dictionary.

Update checks

StageMic checks for a newer stable release at launch. An internet connection is needed for that check to succeed, but a failed background check does not prevent StageMic from opening or interrupt a running show. You can also use **File → Check for Updates**. See Installing and Updating.

Collaboration computers

Each host and remote runs the StageMic desktop app with its own valid licensed session. Use the same StageMic version on every participating computer. Browser-only backstage displays still need no licence.

The host and remotes must be able to communicate over the local network. Collaboration uses TCP port 8911, with automatic discovery over UDP port 49141. If discovery is blocked, connect using the host address. See Connecting to a Show.

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Installing and Updating

Download StageMic from the StageMic download page. Choose the appropriate download for your operating system and processor.

Installing on macOS

1. Extract the downloaded archive.
2. Move **StageMic.app** into your **Applications** folder.
3. Open StageMic.
4. If macOS blocks the first launch because the developer cannot be verified, open **System Settings → Privacy & Security** and look for the option to allow StageMic to open.
5. Activate StageMic with your licence key.

Current macOS builds are not notarised for distribution, so a security warning may appear on first launch. Only allow a copy downloaded from the official StageMic distribution links.

macOS may also ask for permission to access StageMic’s secure storage in Keychain. This protects locally stored licence credentials; it does store the licence itself.

Installing on Windows

Installer

1. Run the downloaded StageMic setup executable.
2. Approve the administrator prompt.
3. Follow the installation wizard.
4. Open StageMic using its desktop or Start menu shortcut.
5. Activate StageMic with your licence key.

The installer registers `.mic` files with StageMic. Windows may still ask you to choose an application the first time you open one.

Portable ZIP

1. Extract the downloaded StageMic portable ZIP.

2. Run StageMic.exe
3. Accept the UAC Prompt if it appears
4. Activate StageMic with your licence key.

The portable ZIP does not register `.mic` files. Open your showfiles with Cmd/Ctrl + O.

Current Windows builds are not Authenticode signed. Windows may display a security warning. If offered, choose **More info → Run anyway** after checking that the file came from the official StageMic distribution links.

Checking for updates

StageMic checks GitHub for a newer stable release quietly at launch. If one is available, a dismissible banner appears in the editor. **Download** opens the StageMic download page.

Use **File → Check for Updates** to check manually. This command is in the File menu, not the main header. It reports whether a newer version is available, the installed version is current, or the check could not be completed.

Checks compare version numbers against GitHub's latest stable release; a newly published older version does not count as an update. Beta and prerelease versions are excluded. Closely spaced successful checks may reuse a result for up to one minute.

A failed background check stays quiet. StageMic does not automatically download, install or restart for an update, and update checks do not interrupt a running show.

Updating StageMic

Before updating:

1. Use **Save** to create a separate `.mic` backup of your current show.
2. Finish any running show session.
3. Quit StageMic.

On **macOS**, replace the existing application in Applications with the new version.

On **Windows**, run the new installer.

StageMic stores autosave, activation and computer settings separately from the application. Updating normally preserves them. You should not need to deactivate your licence simply to install an update on the same computer.

After updating, open your show and check its allocations, network connections and OSC control before the next performance. Do not update to a new version of StageMic during a production run.

Opening show files

On macOS and installed Windows builds, double-clicking a `.mic` file can open it in StageMic. Windows portable ZIP users should use Load unless a file association has been configured manually.

If another application opens it instead, change the file association in your operating system:

- **macOS:** select a `.mic` file in Finder, choose **Get Info → Open with → StageMic**, then **Change All**.
- **Windows:** use **Open with** to choose StageMic and make it the default application for `.mic` files.

You can always open a show using **Load** inside StageMic.

Uninstalling

If you want to release a paid licence's activation slot, use **Licence → Deactivate this computer** while connected to the internet, before uninstalling.

The Windows uninstaller offers an **optional deactivation checkbox**, initially unticked. Select it if you want StageMic to attempt to release this computer's activation before removal. Updates and silent uninstalls skip this step. This option is not available on macOS.

If deactivation fails, choose Retry, Abort or Ignore. Ignore continues uninstalling without confirming release; it does not permanently destroy a licence slot. Reinstall and deactivate using the original Windows account, or contact support if you cannot release it yourself.

The helper uses the Windows account running the uninstaller. If administrator elevation uses a different account, deactivate inside StageMic under your original account first.

Removing the application may also leave autosave and settings data on the computer. Uninstalling should not be treated as a way to erase your show data or reset a trial.

Updating a collaborative setup

Finish the session and update the host and all remotes to the same StageMic version before reconnecting. Keep a separate saved show backup. Collaboration is disabled at launch; enable it again and approve the remotes when you are ready.

Browser-based backstage displays do not need a separate app update. The collaboration protocol remains incompatible with v1.14 and earlier.

Licence agreement

StageMic presents its bundled licence agreement before activation or show services when acceptance is required. Read it and accept to continue, or decline to quit. The agreement is available offline and acceptance is remembered for the current operating-system user account.

Windows portable archive

Extract the entire portable archive and run StageMic.exe. Keep its accompanying files together.

GENERAL

Licences and Activation

StageMic requires a valid licensed session on every computer running the desktop app, including collaboration hosts and remotes. Browser-based backstage display devices do not need separate licences.

Licensing is handled through Keygen.

Activating StageMic

1. Connect the computer to the internet.
2. Open StageMic and accept the licence agreement when prompted.
3. Enter your licence key on the **Licence** screen.
4. Select **Activate this computer**.
5. Once activation succeeds, select **Continue to show** to begin working. When you open Licence during an active session, use **← Back to show** to return to the editor.

Keep your licence key somewhere safe. Do not include it in screenshots or public bug reports.

Activation limits

Your licence determines how many computers can be activated at the same time. For almost all full licences, the limit is 2 machines, which you may use for any purpose within your organisation.

Each activated computer uses a machine slot. Installing an update on the same computer normally retains the existing activation.

If you reach your activation limit, deactivate a computer you no longer use.

Standard licences and offline use

Standard licences are checked online when a new session starts, and retain a monthly offline allowance for each computer. A successful online refresh updates that computer’s saved allowance. Checking in another computer using the same key does not refresh this computer’s saved certificate.

After a successful activation or check-in, the Licence screen shows your **offline check-in deadline**. You can start StageMic offline while that allowance remains valid.

Use the displayed date and time when planning offline use. Do not assume the deadline will be the same time of day as your last activation.

To check in manually:

1. Connect to the internet.
2. Choose **File → Licence** or press **Cmd/Ctrl+Shift+L**.
3. Select **Check in now**.

Check your allowance before travelling to a venue where internet access may be unavailable.

Running show sessions

A session that begins with a valid licence stays running if its check-in deadline passes.

Losing internet access or reaching a check-in deadline does not stop the editor, OSC control or backstage displays during that session.

If a check-in becomes due, complete it before closing and reopening StageMic. A new session must meet the licence requirements again.

Deactivation is different: it explicitly ends the session and quits the app.

Moving to another computer

Save your show as a `.mic` file before moving it.

If you need to release the old computer's activation slot:

1. Connect the old computer to the internet.
2. Open **Licence (Cmd/Ctrl + Shift + L)**.
3. Select **Deactivate this computer**.
4. Activate your licence on the new computer.
5. Load your saved show.

Deactivation quits StageMic and stops its backstage displays.

Your show file does not contain your licence activation.

Lost or unavailable computers

If a computer is lost, fails or can no longer run StageMic, contact StageMic support to request release of that machine's activation.

Deleting local licence files does not release the activation slot.

Updating

Licence activation normally persists across StageMic updates on the same computer. You do not need to deactivate before a routine update.

See Installing and Updating.

Multiple operating-system accounts

Activation files are stored separately for each operating-system user account. You should use the same licence on all user accounts of one machine. This will not use multiple activation slots.

Launch checks and unavailable internet

When starting a new session, Standard licences validate the existing activation online. If the connection fails or the licensing service is temporarily unavailable, StageMic can use a valid saved offline certificate.

A Standard licence must still be within its displayed offline allowance.

A confirmed rejection, such as a suspended or expired licence, is different from a connection failure. It prevents a new session and is remembered locally; disconnecting from the internet does not undo that rejection.

Trial licences continue to require online validation for every new session. See Trial Licences.

Activation removed remotely

If the licensing service confirms that this computer's machine activation or its licence no longer exists, StageMic clears the saved activation and returns to the normal licence-key entry screen. It does not reactivate the computer.

Enter a valid key and explicitly activate if you are authorised to use the computer again. A computer that is offline cannot receive remote deactivation immediately; its existing offline allowance still governs access until it can validate.

These checks do not interrupt an already-running show session. If removal is discovered during that session, activation is required before the next one.

Licence screen and agreement

With a licence installed, the key-entry form is hidden so the activation status and available actions take priority. It returns when there is no saved activation.

The bundled licence agreement can be read offline. Acceptance is remembered for this operating-system user account, separately from your show files. Declining quits StageMic. If an updated agreement needs acceptance, StageMic presents it before continuing.

Deactivating an already-removed licence

If the licensing service confirms that the licence or this machine record has already been deleted, Deactivate clears the local activation and follows the normal deactivation behaviour. It does not need to delete the missing record again.

A network failure or unrelated authentication error is not proof of deletion and does not erase the saved activation. Your show files are unaffected.

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Trial Licences

A trial licence lets you evaluate StageMic before deciding whether to purchase a licence.

Trials last seven days **from first activation on a machine (not from registration)**. The Licence screen shows your trial’s expiry date and time.

Starting a trial

1. Obtain a trial key through the current trial-request route on the StageMic website.
2. Install and open StageMic. Accept the licence agreement when prompted.
3. Connect the computer to the internet.
4. Enter your trial key and select **Activate this computer**.
5. Select **Continue to show** to validate the trial and begin a session.

If Keygen has not finished preparing a new trial’s expiry, StageMic automatically waits and retries, showing progress in the Licence window. It reuses the existing machine activation. It can finish sooner than 90 seconds; retries allow up to nine ten-second waits, plus network request time. If preparation still has not finished, StageMic stops and asks you to retry later.

Internet requirements

Trial licences require online validation whenever a new StageMic session starts, as well as a daily licence check-in.

A saved trial activation does not allow a new session to start offline. A successful check-in earlier in the day does not remove the requirement to validate the next session online.

If validation fails because the computer is offline, reconnect and try again.

During a running session

Once a trial session has started successfully, it continues if:

- The internet connection drops.
- The daily check-in deadline passes.
- The trial expiry time is reached.

StageMic does not interrupt a running show because the trial's allowance has ended.

After closing StageMic, starting another session requires an internet connection and an unexpired trial.

When the trial expires

Activate a paid licence to continue starting new sessions after the trial ends.

Your show data remains stored locally. You do not need to recreate your plot when moving from a trial to a paid licence.

Use **Save** to keep a separate `.mic` copy of your work.

Repeat trials

Trials are intended to provide one evaluation period per computer.

Removing the saved trial or obtaining another key does not grant another evaluation period. Trial eligibility is subject to the licensing service's activation records.

If you have a genuine problem evaluating StageMic, contact StageMic support.

Switching to a paid licence

After finishing any running show session:

1. Open **File → Licence**.
2. Remove the saved trial using **Remove trial**.
3. Reopen StageMic.
4. Enter and activate your paid licence key.

Removing a trial quits StageMic. It does not reset the trial period or erase the licensing service's record of that trial.

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Privacy

StageMic stores your show files and autosaved work locally on your computer.

StageMic does not upload your show data or usage analytics to us or any third party provider.

Show data

Your show can contain information such as:

- Production, scene, character and actor names.
- Mic allocations, detected handovers and handover notes.
- Show-specific settings.
- Approvals for intentional multiple-mic allocations.

Saved `.mic` files are stored wherever you choose to save them. Autosave is stored in StageMic's application-data folder.

StageMic does not provide cloud synchronisation. If you choose a cloud-synchronised folder, shared drive or external backup service, that service may copy your files according to its own settings and privacy policies.

Diagnostics

The `File → Copy diagnostics` menu item copies a report to your clipboard. See Reporting a bug for an example.

The report omits licence keys, cast names and show contents, but includes a Machine ID and technical configuration. Review it before posting publicly. The command only copies the report to your clipboard; it does not upload it.

Backstage displays

When you connect backstage displays, StageMic shares live show information directly with those devices over your local network.

This includes the current scene, handovers, actor and character names, current mic allocations, handover notes and completion status.

Display traffic does not need an internet service or a StageMic cloud server. The controlling computer serves the displays directly.

Use a trusted backstage network. The local display connection uses HTTP and is not encrypted, so it should not be exposed directly to the internet or treated as suitable for a public network.

Crew login cookies

The Crew display uses a cookie to remember a successful login.

The cookie:

- Is used for Crew access, not advertising or analytics.
- Does not contain the Crew password.
- Can remain valid across StageMic restarts.
- Is invalidated when the Crew password is changed.
- Expires after up to one year.

Clearing cookies or using private browsing may require another login.

The Crew password is stored as a salted hash on the controlling computer. Crew access settings are stored separately from `.mic` show files.

The complete-only display does not require a Crew password. Any device that can reach that display can use its permitted completion controls.

Display preferences and connections

Display size and Hide completed preferences are stored in the display browser's local storage. They are not included in show files or used for analytics. Clearing browser storage, changing the display server address or port, or using another browser can reset these preferences.

The controlling computer lists connected display tabs by display type, browser/platform and network address. This information stays with the local display service and is not uploaded as analytics.

Update checks

StageMic contacts GitHub's public release API at launch and when you select **File → Check for Updates**. It uses the release version to check whether an update is available. No show data, licence key, machine fingerprint or usage analytics is included in these requests.

GitHub receives normal connection information, including the computer's public IP address. Selecting **Download** opens stagemic.co.uk/get in your browser. Checking for updates does not automatically download or install software.

If the update service cannot be reached, show planning, OSC and backstage displays continue to work within your licence allowance.

Licensing

StageMic contacts Keygen for licence activation, required check-ins and other online licence-management actions. Standard licences also validate their existing activation when a new session starts online. Trials require online validation at each new session.

Licensing requests include the licence key and information needed to identify and validate the computer’s activation. StageMic derives a machine fingerprint from an operating-system identifier.

Your show plot is not included in licence requests.

Licence credentials are protected locally using operating-system secure storage. The number of permitted activations and the requirements for offline use depend on your licence.

AI

AI assisted with StageMic’s development. This does not mean your show is processed by an AI service.

StageMic does not send actor names, show files, allocations or usage analytics to an AI provider.

Information you choose to send

If you contact support, submit feedback or attach a show file to a bug report, the information you submit is shared through that service.

Check screenshots and attachments before sending them, particularly if they contain cast names, private production information or licence details.

We recommend not uploading .mic files to bug reports, instead, send them to StageMic Support.

Collaboration

When enabled, the host advertises the show and computer name for discovery on the local network. After host approval, remotes receive the shared show, including its cast names, allocations and notes, along with live scene and completion information. Computer names, permissions and the tab being viewed are shared to support collaboration.

The host autosaves accepted edits. Approved remotes can save a local copy of the show, including when they have view-only access. Only approve computers and people you trust with that information.

Collaboration traffic uses unencrypted HTTP on the local network. Host approval and permissions control app access; they do not encrypt traffic or verify the identity behind an advertised computer name. Do not expose the collaboration service to the internet. No licence key is sent to the collaboration host.

Licence agreement acceptance

Acceptance of the bundled licence agreement is recorded locally for the operating-system user account, including the agreement version, content hash and acceptance time. This record is separate from `.mic` show files.

Fundamentals

The StageMic Interface

StageMic has a main window for plotting and operating a show, and a separate Settings window for setup.

Main window

The header shows the StageMic branding and production name. Show commands are in the application menus. On macOS, use the menu bar at the top of the screen; on Windows, use the menu at the top of the app.

Menu command	Purpose
Edit → Search…	Highlight an actor or character in the current plot or swaps view.
File → Licence	View activation, check in or deactivate this computer.
File → New	Create a blank show after the save-current-show prompt.
File → Save…	Save a separate `.mic` show file.
File → Load…	Open a show after the save-current-show prompt.
File → Print…	Choose a formatted report.

See Shortcuts

Below the header, **Current scene** and **Next scene →** control what backstage displays show. Selecting a scene does not edit allocations. The summary cards count mics, characters, detected real-scene swaps and unresolved conflicts.

Plot and swaps tabs

- **Mic plot:** edit allocations by physical mic and scene. Fill forward, clear a mic, inspect its planned history or export mic labels.
- **Character plot:** view allocations and handovers by character, mark offstage allocations and open character mic history.
- **Actor plot:** group characters by actor, mark offstage allocations or open a scene wearer list.
- **DCA plot:** plan numbered DCA assignments independently for each scene.
- **Backstage swaps:** review chronological handovers, edit notes and manage completion states. Pre-Show collections are in a separate expandable section.

Search is local to your computer. It highlights matches without changing the shared plot or printed output.

Settings window

Choose **File → Settings…**, or press **Cmd+,** on macOS / **Ctrl+,** on Windows.

The sidebar contains **Production setup**, **Network setup** and **Collaboration**. Settings and the main editor work on the same show; there is no separate Apply button for production edits. Network changes have their own Apply action.

See Settings.

Remote mode

A connected remote has a purple header and **REMOTE** in the window title. The header identifies the host and includes **Disconnect**. This asks for confirmation before returning to the remote's own local show.

File → Save… becomes **File → Save a Copy…**. **New** and **Load** are unavailable while connected. Settings exposes Production setup only, with editing governed by the host's permissions.

Without Scene control permission, the scene dropdown and Next button are hidden. Lost connections disable shared editing and live actions. See Working as a Remote.

Keyboard and menu commands

Action	macOS	Windows
New	⌘N	Ctrl+N
Load	⌘O	Ctrl+O
Save / Save a Copy	⌘S	Ctrl+S
Print	⌘P	Ctrl+P
Search	⌘F	Ctrl+F
Licence	⇧⌘L	Ctrl+Shift+L
Settings	⌘,	Ctrl+,
Undo show edit	⌘Z	Ctrl+Z
Redo show edit	⇧⌘Z	Ctrl+Y

Space advances one scene when no interactive control is focused and no editor dialog is open, provided your computer has scene-control permission. Text inputs retain normal text-editing shortcuts.

File → Connect to Show…, **Disconnect from Show**, **Copy diagnostics** and **Check for Updates** provide connection and support actions. Updates are downloaded through the StageMic website; checks do not install or restart the app.

The five main views use tabs. With a tab focused, use Left/Right to move between them or Home/End to select the first or last tab. Coloured presence indicators show where connected editors are working; hover to see the computer name.

Navigating plots

Mic, Character, Actor and DCA plots remember their own horizontal and vertical scroll positions when you switch tabs in the current window. These positions belong to your computer; they are not saved in the show or shared with collaborators.

Use arrow keys to move between focused plot cells. Enter opens a Mic allocation list or DCA picker, or toggles an allocated Actor/Character cell's offstage marking. See Keyboard Navigation.

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Keyboard Navigation

Keyboard navigation lets you move between plot cells without repeatedly reaching for the mouse. It works in Mic, Character, Actor and DCA plots.

Move between cells

Focus a plot cell with Tab, or click a focusable cell, then use the arrow keys:

Key	Action
Left / Right	Move to the previous or next scene cell in the row.
Up / Down	Move to the corresponding cell in the previous or next row.
Enter	Open the cell's editor, or toggle an allocated Character/Actor cell's offstage mark.

Navigation stops at the edge of the grid; it does not wrap to another row.

When an input, select list or button has focus, its normal keyboard behaviour takes priority. Escape from a control inside a plot cell returns focus to the cell.

Edit a Mic allocation

1. Focus the required Mic plot cell.
2. Press **Enter** to open the keyboard allocation list.
3. Use arrow keys or type-to-select to choose a character, **Mic table** or **Unassigned**.
4. Press **Enter** to confirm, or **Escape** to cancel.

Both confirmation and cancellation return focus directly to the source cell. Arrow keys then navigate cells again, without a second Escape press. Changing the highlighted option alone does not save it until confirmed.

The normal dropdown remains available for mouse editing.

Character and Actor plots

Enter or Space on an allocated cell toggles its offstage marking. It does not change which mic the wearer has. Empty and handover-only cells cannot be marked.

Use Mic plot to change the allocation itself.

DCA plot

Enter on a DCA cell opens the assignment picker. Use its search field and checkboxes, then Save or Cancel. See DCA Plot.

Tabs and show control

With a main tab button focused, Left/Right switches tabs and Home/End selects the first or last tab.

Space advances the live scene only when no interactive control or plot cell is focused and no editor dialog is open, and only when you have scene-control permission. Editing or navigating a plot does not select a live scene.

For application shortcuts such as Save, Print, Search and Undo, see The StageMic Interface.

Permissions

Navigation is available while viewing a shared show. Editing an allocation, offstage mark or DCA requires **Edit show** permission. Keyboard controls do not bypass permissions or a lost connection.

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Settings

Settings opens in a separate window so you can manage setup without replacing the main plot view.

Open it with **File → Settings…**, **Cmd+,** on macOS or **Ctrl+,** on Windows.

While the window opens, **Opening settings…** confirms that your request is being handled. Repeated clicks reuse the same Settings window.

Sidebar pages

Page	Purpose	Storage
Production setup	Production name, actors, characters, scenes, mic count and incomplete-handover alerts	Saved with the show and autosave
Network setup	Display and OSC interfaces, ports, display links, Crew password and connected displays	Stored on the controlling computer
Collaboration	Enable hosting, approve remotes and set permissions	Managed for the current session

Production edits apply to the current show immediately. Network changes use **Apply network settings** and a confirmation. Closing Settings does not cancel edits already made.

Collaboration

On the host, all three pages are available. On a remote, Settings shows Production setup for the shared show. Edit show permission is required to change it.

The main window and Settings window refer to the same active show. A change made in either appears in the other and is shared with connected remotes.

Only the host manages the shared show’s network services, Crew password and collaboration permissions.

Which settings travel with a show?

A `.mic` file includes production data and show-specific options such as incomplete-handover alerts. It does not transfer network addresses, ports, Crew credentials, remote approvals or licence activation.

See Production Setup, Network Setup and Hosting a Show.

Closing with unsaved network changes

If network settings have been changed but not applied, closing Settings offers **Save**, **Discard** or **Cancel**. Save applies the changes and closes the window; Discard closes it without applying the draft; Cancel keeps the window and your draft open. If applying the settings fails, the window remains open so you can correct them.

This prompt concerns unapplied network settings. Production edits already apply immediately.

FUNDAMENTALS

Search

Search highlights actors or characters in your plot without changing allocations or hiding other entries.

Open search

Choose **Edit → Search…**, or press **Cmd+F** on macOS / **Ctrl+F** on Windows.

Choose **Actor** or **Character**, then enter all or part of a name. Matching is not case-sensitive. Actor searches use the actor links in Production setup; an unlinked character will not match an actor search.

Where matches appear

- **Mic plot:** matching allocations and handover cells.
- **Character plot:** matching character rows.
- **Actor plot:** matching actor or linked-character rows.
- **DCA plot:** cells containing selected characters that match the actor or character search.
- **Backstage swaps:** matching outgoing or incoming wearers, including Pre-Show collections in their collapsed section.

Your query stays active when switching views. The match count describes the current view, so a highlighted row and a highlighted cell are counted according to that view. Expand Pre-Show collections to inspect matches there.

Clear search

Clear the name field to remove highlights, or select **Close search** to clear the query and hide the controls.

Search does not change the live scene, completion status, printed reports, CSV exports or copied tables.

Collaboration

Search is per computer. Searching or clearing a query on a remote does not change another editor’s query, the live scene or the plot. Coloured tab indicators show where connected editors are working; hover over an indicator to see the computer name.

DCA picker search

The search field inside a DCA assignment dialog filters that character list only. It does not change the main plot search. Selected characters remain selected when hidden by the picker search.

FUNDAMENTALS

Undo and Redo

Undo and redo let you revise show edits without manually reconstructing the previous plot.

Commands

Action	macOS	Windows
Undo	Cmd+Z	Ctrl+Z
Redo	Cmd+Shift+Z	Ctrl+Y

The commands are also available in the **Edit** menu. While a text input is focused, they apply to its text editing instead of the show history. Move focus away from the text input to undo a show edit.

Show edits

History includes allocation changes, fill forward, clearing a mic, moving a mic's allocations, mic-count changes, names and actor links, scene splitting, reordering, intentional double-mic approvals, handover-note edits and the incomplete-handover alert setting.

A fill, split or drag drop is one editing step. Undo reverses that operation as a whole. A new edit after undo clears the redo history.

Undo and redo results are autosaved. Save again if you want to update a separate `.mic` copy.

Live operations

Show-edit undo does not reverse live scene changes, handover completion ticks, network settings or licence actions. Use the completion controls in Backstage swaps or a Crew display to correct a tick.

An allocation or scene edit can change detected handovers. Review their timing and completion status after substantial revisions.

History and backups

History holds up to 100 editing steps per editor, subject to a shared memory limit that may discard older steps sooner. It is managed by the running app rather than saved inside `.mic` files. Creating or loading a show clears it, and restarting StageMic does not restore it. Do not rely on undo as a backup.

Creating or loading a show cannot be undone to recover the previous show. Keep separate saved backups for that purpose. See Saving, Autosaving, and Loading.

Collaboration

Each editor has its own undo and redo history. Undo reverses your own accepted changes, not the most recent change made by anyone.

The host checks the operation against the current show. If another editor has changed the same information, undo can be refused instead of overwriting their work. Review the current show before making a new edit.

Current permissions still apply: a remote cannot undo an allocation edit after losing Edit show access, or a note edit after losing Completions and swap notes access. Disconnecting and rejoining does not preserve a remote’s undo history.

Undoing a mic move

Moving a whole mic is one editing step. Undo restores its allocations and matching notes, but does not restore completion ticks cleared by the move. During collaboration, StageMic checks both mic rows before accepting the move or its undo so another editor’s changes are not silently overwritten.

Moving a handover to the next eligible scene and resetting its timing are show edits and can be undone or redone.

Offstage and DCA edits

Offstage markings, DCA assignments and changes to the DCA count support show-edit undo and redo. Changing your scroll position, opening character history or exporting a collection list is not a show edit. Remote edits and their undo still require **Edit show** permission.

FUNDAMENTALS

Shows and .mic Files

A StageMic show is the allocation plan for a production: its scenes, characters, actors and mics, together with who wears each mic in each scene.

StageMic saves shows using the `.mic` extension.

What a show file contains

A `.mic` file includes:

- The production name.
- Scenes and their order.
- Characters and their order.
- Actors and their character links.
- Numbered mics.
- Scene-by-scene allocations.
- Explicit Mic table assignments.
- Handover notes, including Pre-Show collection notes.
- Intentional multiple-mic approvals.
- Offstage markings for character allocations.

- The number of DCAs and their character assignments for each scene.
- The incomplete-handover alert setting.

Scenes also have internal identifiers. These keep scene-specific OSC addresses attached to the correct scene when you rename or reorder it.

What is stored separately

The following belong to the controlling computer and are not included in a `.mic` file:

- Licence activation.
- Display and OSC network settings.
- The Crew password and remembered Crew access.
- Handover completion records.

Display size and Hide completed preferences belong to each display browser and are not saved in `.mic` files.

Sending someone a show file does not send your licence or Crew password. It also does not transfer the completion ticks from a performance.

Opening a show

Use **Load** to open a `.mic` file.

Where the operating system associates `.mic` files with StageMic, you can also double-click a file to open it.

StageMic asks whether you want to save the current show before replacing it. Cancelling leaves the current show open.

Moving and sharing shows

A `.mic` file can be copied, emailed or moved between computers.

The receiving computer needs its own valid StageMic activation to open the editor. Configure its network settings separately and check the backstage displays before use.

Show files can contain cast names and production information. Check that you are happy to share those details before sending a file.

Backups

Autosave protects your current work, but it is not a history of previous versions.

Use **Save** to keep separate backups, particularly before major plotting changes or an application update. Descriptive filenames make versions easier to identify, for example:

```
Example Production – Before Technical Rehearsal.mic
```

See Saving, Autosaving, and Loading.

Undo history

Show-edit undo history is temporary and separate from autosave or saved `.mic` files. It holds up to 100 editing steps per editor, subject to a shared memory limit that may discard older steps sooner. It resets when you create or load a show, and is not restored after a restart. Undo and redo results are autosaved. Use saved backups for longer-term recovery. See Undo and Redo.

Shared shows

Collaboration edits one active show on the host; it does not synchronise independent `.mic` files in the background. The host autosaves accepted edits. Remotes may save a separate copy, but their local autosaves remain their own shows. Network settings, permissions and activation are not transferred inside the show file.

File limits

StageMic accepts shows with up to **50 mics** and rejects files larger than **16 MB** before parsing them. A rejected Load leaves the current show in place. For startup recovery options, see Show Files and Autosave Recovery.

Handover timing choices made in Mic plot are stored in `.mic` files and autosave. Use v1.18 on computers that need to preserve and edit those choices.

Version compatibility

Use v1.18 when editing shows that contain offstage markings or DCA plans. An older version may open the allocation grid but will not display or maintain newer features correctly during edits. Keep a separate backup before opening a show in an older version.

Plot scroll positions are temporary, per-window preferences; they are not part of the show file.

FUNDAMENTALS

Saving, Autosaving, and Loading

StageMic automatically saves your current show as you work. You can also save separate `.mic` files for backups, sharing and use on another computer.

Autosave

Changes made in the editor are automatically written to StageMic’s local autosave file.

When StageMic next opens, it restores the autosaved show.

Autosave is stored in the application-data folder on the controlling computer. It is separate from any `.mic` files you save yourself.

Save

Choose **File → Save…**, or press Cmd/Ctrl + S, choose a filename and location, then confirm the save.

This creates or replaces a `.mic` file containing the current show.

Autosave does not continuously update that separate file. Select Save again when you want to update your saved copy.

Saving separate files is useful for:

- Keeping a backup before substantial changes.
- Recording a rehearsal or performance version.
- Sending the plot to another StageMic user.
- Moving the show to another computer.

Load

Choose **File → Load…** or press Cmd/Ctrl + O and choose a `.mic` file.

Before replacing the current show, StageMic asks:

> **Save the current show before opening another?**

You can choose to:

- Save the current show, then open the selected file.
- Open the selected file without saving a separate copy of the current show.
- Cancel and keep the current show open.

If you choose to save but cancel the save dialog, StageMic does not replace the current show. A failed save also stops the replacement.

The same protection applies when opening a show through the operating system.

New

Choose **File → New** or press Cmd/Ctrl + N to create a blank show.

StageMic asks whether you want to save the current show first. You can save and continue, continue without saving, or cancel.

Once the blank show becomes the current show, autosave follows that new show. Save anything you want to keep before replacing it.

Autosave and backups

Autosave keeps the current state of your work. It does not provide a list of earlier versions to restore.

For example, deleting an allocation is a change that autosave will also record. A separate saved copy gives you a point to return to.

A useful routine is to save a named backup:

- Before a major revision.
- Before installing an update.
- Before moving the show to another computer.
- Once the plot is agreed for a performance.

After loading

Check the production name, scene order and allocations.

Loading a show does not import another computer's network settings, Crew password or licence activation. Handover completion records are also stored separately.

See Shows and .mic Files.

Undo history

Show-edit undo history is temporary and separate from autosave or saved `.mic` files. It holds up to 100 editing steps per editor, subject to a shared memory limit that may discard older steps sooner. It resets when you create or load a show, and is not restored after a restart. Undo and redo results are autosaved. Use saved backups for longer-term recovery. See Undo and Redo.

While collaborating

The host autosaves the shared show, including accepted remote edits. Saving on the host creates the separate show file used for backups.

A remote's **Save a Copy** writes the current shared plot to a file on that remote. It does not change the host's saved filename or overwrite the remote's own local autosave. Completion records are not included.

Before connecting, StageMic offers to save the remote's local show. That local autosave is retained while connected. Confirming Disconnect returns to it.

Only the host can create or load another show during collaboration. Doing so disconnects remotes and disables Collaboration; enable it again when ready. See Saving and Leaving a Shared Show.

Rejected files

StageMic accepts shows with up to **50 mics** and rejects files larger than **16 MB** before parsing them. A rejected Load leaves the current show in place. For startup recovery options, see Show Files and Autosave Recovery.

FUNDAMENTALS

Scenes

Scenes divide your show into the points at which StageMic records mic allocations.

A scene can represent a dramatic scene, a musical number, an interval or another useful point in the production. Choose divisions that make sense for your mic plot and backstage workflow.

Scene names

Each scene has a name, which appears in plots, reports, the current-scene selector and backstage displays.

Names can be simple numbers, descriptive titles or a mixture of both.

For example:

- `Scene 1`
- `Scene 2`
- `INTERVAL`
- `Act 2 Overture`
- `Scene 22 — The Station`

Scene order

The order in Production setup is the chronological order of the show.

StageMic uses that order to:

- Arrange plot columns.
- Advance with **Next scene →**.
- Interpret numeric OSC scene selection.
- Determine where handovers can happen.
- Decide whether a scene change qualifies for an incomplete-handover alert.

An interval can be included as a scene if you want to plot allocations or handovers during it.

Adding scenes

Add scenes in **Settings → Production setup**.

Type a scene name and press Enter, or select **Add scene**. New scenes are added to the end of the list.

Renaming and reordering

Rename a scene in Production setup. Drag its grip to reorder it, or use the existing up and down controls.

Reordering moves the scene together with its allocations. Renaming changes its displayed name without creating a new scene.

Each scene has a stable internal identifier. Its individual OSC cue address remains attached to that scene when it is renamed or reordered.

Numeric OSC messages select by position, so their meaning can change when scenes are inserted, removed or reordered.

Splitting a scene

Select **Split** beside a scene in Production setup. A scene named `2` becomes `2 Part 1` and `2 Part 2`, with the same allocations in both parts. Rename and edit either part afterwards.

Part 1 keeps the original scene identifier and OSC address. Part 2 receives a new identifier. Later numeric scene positions shift by one. Intentional double-mic approvals, offstage markings and the scene's DCA plan are copied into Part 2. The split can be undone as one edit.

Removing scenes

Removing a scene also removes its allocation column.

Save a backup first if you may need to recover the scene and its allocations later.

Pre-Show

StageMic provides a built-in **Pre-Show** entry in the live scene selector. It is not a user-created scene and does not appear in Production setup, plots or normal reports. A separate pre-show collection PDF is available on request. It does not change numeric scene positions. See Pre-Show.

Current scene

The current scene is the point currently shown on backstage displays.

Choosing it does not edit the plot or automatically mark handovers completed. It selects which part of the existing plan is being shown to the crew.

See Selecting and Advancing Scenes.

FUNDAMENTALS

Characters and Actors

StageMic separates the role in the show from the person playing it.

A **character** is assigned to a mic in the plot.

An **actor** is linked to one or more characters in Production setup.

Characters

Create a character for each role you need to allocate a mic to.

A character can be a named dramatic role, an ensemble role or another useful label, such as `Narrator` or `Ensemble 3`.

Characters appear as allocation choices in the Mic plot and as rows in the Character plot.

Character names must be unique within the show.

Actors

Actors represent the people wearing the mics.

Linking characters to actors allows StageMic to:

- Group their characters in the Actor plot.
- Display actor names prominently in backstage handovers.
- Identify allocations involving the same person.
- Produce individual actor reports.

You can build a plot without actor links, but StageMic then has no information about who physically wears each mic.

Linking characters to actors

In **Settings → Production setup**:

1. Add the actor to the Actors list.
2. Find the character in the Characters list.
3. Choose the actor from that character’s dropdown.

Each character can be linked to one actor. One actor can be linked to several characters.

Actors playing multiple characters

If an actor plays several characters, link all those characters to the same actor.

Their allocations appear together in the Actor plot.

A change of character on the same mic does not create a handover when both characters are linked to the same actor. The wearer has not changed.

If those characters are allocated different mics in the same scene, StageMic flags the multiple allocation for review. You can mark it as intentional where appropriate.

Characters without actors

Unlinked characters still work in the Mic and Character plots.

They appear separately in the Actor plot, labelled as having no actor assigned. They are not selectable as actors in the individual actor report picker.

Link them to actors if you want named actor reports and actor-based handover information.

Editing names and order

Characters and actors can be renamed and reordered in Production setup.

Use these controls rather than deleting and recreating an entry when you only want to change its name.

After changing actor links, review the detected swaps and any multiple-mic warnings. StageMic’s understanding of the physical wearer may have changed.

FUNDAMENTALS

Mics and Allocations

Each numbered mic in StageMic represents a physical radio pack that can move between wearers during the show.

An allocation records which character is assigned that mic in a particular scene.

Numbered mics

Set the number of mics in **Settings → Production setup**.

StageMic creates numbered mics from 1 to the number entered. Mics do not need individual names.

Use a numbering scheme that your crew can match to the physical packs.

Increasing the count preserves existing allocations. Reducing it removes the highest-numbered mics and their allocations after confirmation.

Making an allocation

In the **Mic plot**:

1. Find the row for the mic.
2. Find the column for the scene.
3. Choose a character from the cell’s dropdown.

The Character and Actor plots update from the same allocation data.

If the character is linked to an actor, StageMic uses that link to identify the wearer.

Blank cells

A blank allocation means no wearer has been specified for that mic in that scene.

It does not explicitly record a return to the mic table.

Blank scenes can provide a gap in which a handover is placed. StageMic compares the surrounding assignments to detect a change of wearer.

For example:

Mic	Scene 1	Scene 2	Scene 3
1	John	Unassigned (The handover will be placed here)	Alice

StageMic places the handover in Scene 2, the first unassigned scene after John’s allocation.

Mic table

Choose **Mic table** when you want to record an explicit return to or collection from the table.

Unlike a blank cell, it identifies a specific destination between wearers.

See Mic Table.

Filling forward

The → button copies a selected wearer into following blank scenes.

It stops before the next existing assignment, including a Mic table assignment.

This is useful for actors who keep the same mic for a long section of the show.

See Filling Allocations Forward.

Clearing a mic

Click a mic number in the Mic plot to clear that mic’s allocations across the show, after confirmation.

To clear one scene only, choose the unassigned option in that cell.

Multiple mics

StageMic flags cases where the same character or linked actor has multiple mics in one scene.

If this is deliberate, mark the allocation as intentional. Both mics remain in the plot.

See Conflicts and Intentional Double-Mic'ing.

Mic count and moving a whole mic

A show supports **0–50 mics**. Reducing the count removes the highest-numbered mics; StageMic identifies occupied mics before you confirm.

Use **Settings → Production setup → Move allocations…** to move an entire mic’s allocations to another number without creating duplicate assignments. See Moving Mic Allocations.

FUNDAMENTALS

Mic Table

Mic table is a special allocation used to record a mic being returned to or collected from the table.

It helps distinguish a direct handover between people from a return followed by a later collection.

Assigning Mic table

In the **Mic plot**, choose **Mic table** from the allocation dropdown for the relevant mic and scene.

Use it at the point in the plot where the return should be shown.

Return and collection

Consider this allocation:

Mic	Scene 1	Scene 2	Scene 3	Scene 4	Scene 5
1	John	Mic table	Mic table	Unassigned	Alice

StageMic detects two changes:

- John returns mic 1 to the table in Scene 2.
- Alice collects mic 1 from the table in Scene 4.

These are separate handovers, with separate completion states.

Mic table and blank scenes

A blank cell does not explicitly say where the mic is.

For example:

Mic	Scene 1	Scene 2	Scene 3
1	John	Unassigned	Alice

This produces a direct John-to-Alice handover in Scene 2.

Mic table should be used when the mic remains at the table across multiple scenes.

Several scenes at the table

A mic can remain assigned to Mic table across several scenes.

Consecutive Mic table assignments do not create repeated return handovers. StageMic shows the return when the mic first moves from a wearer to the table.

A later assignment to a character creates a collection.

Returning without a new wearer

A Mic table assignment can record a return even if nobody collects the mic later in the show.

This is useful when you want that return included in the backstage plan.

A planning instruction

Selecting Mic table records the intended location in the plot. It does not confirm that the pack has physically arrived.

Cast/crew should mark the corresponding handover completed when the return or collection has happened.

Pre-Show and available mics

Characters allocated mics in the first real scene receive automatic collections in Pre-Show without an earlier Mic table scene. See Pre-Show.

The Mic plot footer counts explicit Mic table assignments as available mics in each scene. Blank allocations are not counted. Hover over, focus or click a count to see the mic numbers.

FUNDAMENTALS

Understanding Handovers

StageMic detects handovers by following each mic through the scene allocations.

A handover is a change from one wearer to another, a return to the mic table or a collection from it.

The interface also refers to these as **swaps**.

Direct changes

If a mic changes wearer between consecutive scenes, StageMic places the handover in the receiving scene.

Mic	Scene 1	Scene 2
1	John	Alice

The John-to-Alice handover appears in Scene 2. This is not an ideal scenario as the handover will not have time to occur.

Changes across blank scenes

If there is a gap between wearers, StageMic places the handover in the first unassigned scene after the previous allocation.

Mic	Scene 1	Scene 2	Scene 3	Scene 4
1	John	Unassigned (The handover will occur here.)	Unassigned	Alice

The John-to-Alice handover appears in Scene 2.

This gives the crew the earliest scene in the gap where the change can be planned.

Returns and collections

An explicit **Mic table** assignment separates a return from a later collection.

Mic	Scene 1	Scene 2	Scene 3
1	John	Mic table	Alice

In this case, StageMic shows John returning the mic in Scene 2 and Alice collecting it in Scene 3. It is not desirable to have this scenario, and so you should include an unassigned scene after the Mic table allocation if the collection needs an earlier plotting point.

See Mic Table.

Character changes on the same actor

If two characters are linked to the same actor, changing between those characters on the same mic does not create a handover.

The character has changed, but the physical wearer has not.

Accurate actor links are therefore useful when plotting actors who play multiple roles.

Initial allocations

A character allocated a mic in the **first real scene** automatically receives a **Mic table → wearer** collection in **Pre-Show**. These collections appear in Pre-Show, never in scene 1, and are excluded from all plots, reports and exports.

A blank or Mic table allocation in the first scene creates no Pre-Show collection. StageMic does not look ahead to find a later first wearer. Later collections still follow the normal allocation rules. You do not need extra Setup or Pre-show scenes for first-scene collections. See Pre-Show.

Similarly, an allocation followed only by blank scenes does not create an automatic return. Use Mic table to record an explicit return.

Reviewing timing

Detected handovers are based on your scene allocations. StageMic does not know when actors enter or leave, how long a change takes or if/where crew will meet them.

Review every handover against the practical running of the show during Tech Rehearsals.

If a change needs its own plotting point, you can add a scene representing that point and allocate the mic accordingly.

Completion tracking

Marking a handover completed records backstage progress. It does not change the allocation plan.

Current allocations continue to show the plotted wearer for the selected scene, whether or not the corresponding handover has been ticked.

Before each performance, reset completion tracking so that the new performance begins with pending handovers.

See Handover Completion.

Adding practical instructions

Add a note to a detected handover in Backstage Swaps to tell crew where or when to meet the wearer. Both display types show the note on its card. Notes do not move the handover. Use the Mic plot timing controls to move an eligible handover later within its unassigned gap.

Moving a handover later

In **Mic plot**, select **Move to next scene** beneath an eligible handover. This moves the change into the following scene only when that scene is **Unassigned** for the same mic and remains within the blank gap before the receiving allocation. Repeat to move through a longer gap.

Select **Reset timing** in the destination cell to restore automatic placement in the earliest available scene. These controls are in Mic plot, not Backstage swaps. They do not change who is allocated the mic.

You cannot move a handover past an assigned character, Mic table or the receiving allocation. Pre-Show collections always remain in Pre-Show.

Timing choices are saved in the show and autosave, shared with collaborators, and support undo/redo. A remote needs **Edit show** permission. If later edits make a chosen gap invalid, StageMic returns to automatic timing; review the resulting handovers.

Displays, alerts, plot handover markers, mic history and handover reports use the chosen scene. Notes remain attached. Moving a completed handover creates a new completion at its new timing, so it must be marked complete again.

Printed reports show the revised handover only. Move/reset controls and “No swap” labels are never printed.

FUNDAMENTALS

Conflicts and Intentional Double-Mic'ing

StageMic highlights multiple-mic allocations so that you can check whether they are mistakes or deliberate parts of the plot.

A warning appears when more than one mic is assigned to:

- The same character in a scene.
- Characters linked to the same actor in a scene.

The affected plot cells are highlighted red.

Reviewing a warning

Check the allocation before approving it.

Common causes include:

- Assigning a character to a new mic without clearing the previous one.
- Filling an allocation forward further than intended.
- Allocating different characters to different mics without noticing that one actor plays both.

Correct an accidental allocation in the Mic plot.

Intentional multiple mics

Some performers deliberately wear more than one mic, such as a principal wearing a main and backup pack.

In that case, select **Mark as intentional** on the affected allocation.

StageMic replaces the red conflict warning with an **Intentional double-mic** label. The allocation no longer contributes to the unresolved conflict count.

Approval records that you have reviewed the allocation. It does not remove either mic or combine them into one pack.

Apply to matching scenes

Select **Apply to matching scenes** to approve the same allocation in all currently matching scenes.

Matching includes the wearer, mic combination and character assignments.

This is useful when an actor wears the same two packs throughout a section of the show.

It applies to matching scenes that exist at the time you select it. It does not automatically approve future allocations.

What an approval covers

An approval applies to the exact allocation in a particular scene.

StageMic requires review again if you change the wearer, mic combination or character allocation.

Renaming or reordering a scene preserves the approval attached to that scene. Splitting a scene copies its allocations and intentional approvals into Part 2. Later changes to either part may require review again.

Approvals are saved in `.mic` files and autosave, so they travel with the show.

Restoring a warning

Select **Review assignment** to remove approval from that scene.

The allocation becomes an unresolved conflict again and returns to red highlighting.

Reviewing one scene does not remove approval from other matching scenes.

Plots, reports and handovers

Both mics remain visible in the plots and reports.

Printed plots and individual actor reports show the intentional status without a red conflict warning.

Each mic also retains its own detected handovers and completion controls. Approving a double-mic allocation does not approve, complete or suppress the associated physical changes.

Plotting a Show

Production Setup

Production setup defines the people, scenes and mics used in your show.

You can return to this page at any time to make changes. Changes are automatically applied.

Production name

Enter the name of your production in **Production name**.

The name appears in the editor, backstage displays and printed reports.

It does not need to be the same as the file name.

Characters

Characters are the roles you assign to mics.

To add a character:

1. Enter a name in the Characters section.
2. Press Enter or select **Add character**.

The input remains available so you can continue entering the cast using the keyboard.

Character names must be unique within the show.

Each character’s row provides controls to:

- Rename the character.
- Choose the actor playing it.
- Drag its grip to reorder it, or move it up or down.
- Remove it.

Actors

Actors identify the people playing your characters.

To add an actor:

1. Enter their name in the Actors section.
2. Press Enter or select **Add actor**.

Then choose that actor beside each character they play.

One actor can be linked to several characters. Those characters share a row in the Actor plot.

You can rename, reorder or remove actors using their row controls.

Scenes

To add a scene:

1. Enter its name in the Scenes section.
2. Press Enter or select **Add scene**.

Scenes are added in production order. Drag their grips to adjust that order, or use the up and down controls. Actors and characters can also be reordered by dragging.

Scene names can be numbers, titles or other useful labels. Include an interval or other transition as a scene if you want to plot allocations during it.

Renaming and reordering scenes keeps their allocations attached.

Splitting scenes

Select **Split** on a scene row to create Part 1 and Part 2 with identical allocations. Part 1 retains the original scene ID; Part 2 receives a new one. Both names can be edited. See Scenes.

The built-in Pre-Show is not listed or edited in Production setup. Its collections are derived from allocations in the first real scene.

Radio packs

Enter a whole number from **0 to 50** and press Enter or select **Set mic count**.

StageMic creates numbered mics from 1 to the number entered.

Increasing the count keeps the existing allocations and adds more mics. Reducing it removes the highest-numbered mics and their allocations after confirmation. The confirmation identifies occupied mics that would be removed. To keep their work, use **Move allocations…** beside the mic count first. See Moving Mic Allocations.

Incomplete-handover alerts

Enable **Alert me about handovers not marked complete** if you want warnings when advancing from a scene with pending handovers.

This setting is off by default and is saved with the show.

Alerts apply when moving forward exactly one scene. They do not stop scene advancement or interrupt backstage displays.

See Incomplete Handover Alerts.

After setup

Open the **Mic plot** to begin assigning characters to mics.

You do not need to finish every part of Production setup first. You can add actors, adjust scenes and expand the mic count as the plot develops.

Opening setup and remote access

Open **Settings… → Production setup** using the main window or Cmd/Ctrl+,.

The Settings window and main plot share the same show. Close Settings to return to the plot; changes do not require another save/apply action to take effect.

On a remote, Production setup displays the shared show. **Edit show** permission is required to change it. Network setup and Collaboration management remain on the host.

PLOTTING A SHOW

Mic Plot

The Mic plot is where you edit the show’s mic allocations.

Each row represents a physical mic. Each column represents a scene.

Assigning a character

Find the cell where the mic row and scene column meet, then choose a character from its dropdown.

The same allocation immediately appears in the Character and Actor plots.

Choose the unassigned option to clear that cell, or **Mic table** to record an explicit return to or collection from the table.

Reading the plot

A cell can contain:

- The assigned character.
- A detected handover involving that mic.
- A multiple-mic warning.
- An intentional double-mic label.

Handovers appear in the scene where StageMic places the change. This may be an unassigned scene before the next wearer’s allocation.

See Understanding Handovers.

Filling forward

Select a wearer, then press the cell’s → button to copy that allocation into following blank scenes.

Filling stops before the next existing assignment, including Mic table.

See Filling Allocations Forward.

Clearing allocations

To clear one cell, choose the unassigned option.

To clear a mic throughout the show, click its number on the left and confirm.

Clearing a mic leaves the numbered mic available for new allocations.

See Clearing Allocations.

Multiple-mic warnings

Red cells indicate that a character or linked actor has more than one mic in that scene.

Correct accidental allocations using the dropdowns.

If the allocation is deliberate, use **Mark as intentional** or **Apply to matching scenes**.

See Conflicts and Intentional Double-Mic'ing.

Scrolling

The mic numbers and scene headings stay visible as you scroll around the plot.

For large shows, scroll horizontally to reach later scenes and vertically to reach additional mics.

Available mics

The bottom of each scene column shows the number of mics explicitly assigned to **Mic table**. Blank allocations are not counted as available.

Hover over, focus or click a count to see the available mic numbers. A zero count shows that no mics are assigned to Mic table in that scene. These planning counts are not included in printed plots.

Search

Use **Edit → Search…** or **Cmd/Ctrl+F**, choose **Actor** or **Character**, and enter a name. Matching entries are highlighted without hiding the rest of the plot. Search carries across plot and Backstage swaps views and does not change printed or exported output. See Search.

Undo and redo

Use **Edit → Undo** to reverse a show edit: **Cmd+Z** on macOS or **Ctrl+Z** on Windows. Redo uses **Cmd+Shift+Z** on macOS or **Ctrl+Y** on Windows. Focused text inputs retain their text-editing undo behaviour. See Undo and Redo.

Printing

Use **File → Print… → Mic plot** to produce a formatted report.

Printing uses a separate report layout rather than printing the editor window.

Use **Export CSV** for the allocation grid, or **Export mic labels** for a PDF of bordered labels. See Export CSV Files and Mic Labels.

For large plots, the report picker offers **Fit all mic rows on one page (A4 landscape)**. See Print Reports.

Mic history

Select the information button beside a mic number to see its planned allocations and handovers. Matching wearers are grouped across unassigned gaps, while explicit Mic table entries remain visible. Clicking the mic number itself still clears its allocations after confirmation. See Mic History.

Moving a handover later

In **Mic plot**, select **Move to next scene** beneath an eligible handover. This moves the change into the following scene only when that scene is **Unassigned** for the same mic and remains within the blank gap before the receiving allocation. Repeat to move through a longer gap.

Select **Reset timing** in the destination cell to restore automatic placement in the earliest available scene. These controls are in Mic plot, not Backstage swaps. They do not change who is allocated the mic.

You cannot move a handover past an assigned character, Mic table or the receiving allocation. Pre-Show collections always remain in Pre-Show.

Timing choices are saved in the show and autosave, shared with collaborators, and support undo/redo. A remote needs **Edit show** permission. If later edits make a chosen gap invalid, StageMic returns to automatic timing; review the resulting handovers.

Displays, alerts, plot handover markers, mic history and handover reports use the chosen scene. Notes remain attached. Moving a completed handover creates a new completion at its new timing, so it must be marked complete again.

Printed reports show the revised handover only. Move/reset controls and “No swap” labels are never printed.

Keyboard editing and scroll memory

Focus an allocation cell and use arrow keys to move between cells. Enter opens a keyboard allocation list. Choose a wearer, then press Enter to confirm or Escape to cancel; either action returns focus to the cell so the arrows can navigate again. The usual mouse-operated dropdown remains available.

The Mic plot remembers its horizontal and vertical scroll position when you switch away and back in the same window. See Keyboard Navigation.

PLOTTING A SHOW

Mic History

Mic history lets you inspect one mic's planned journey without scanning its entire plot row.

Open a mic's history

In **Mic plot**, select the information button beside the mic number. The window contains **Allocations** and **Handovers**. Clicking the number itself still opens the clear-mic confirmation.

Allocations

Each entry shows a scene or scene range and its assigned character. Linked actor names appear alongside the character.

Matching wearers are grouped across intervening unassigned scenes. Unassigned periods are not shown as separate entries, and a range ends at the last explicit assignment to that wearer. Explicit **Mic table** assignments remain visible and break wearer groups.

For example:

Scene	Plotted allocation
1–3	Lucy
4	Unassigned
5	Lucy
6	Unassigned
7	Tumnus

History shows **1–5: Lucy** and **7: Tumnus**. The handover from Lucy to Tumnus remains in **scene 6**.

This grouping changes only the history display. It does not fill blank cells or alter the saved plot.

Handovers

The Handovers section lists this mic's detected changes, returns to Mic table and Pre-Show collection where applicable. Each appears at its planned handover scene. Any handover note is also shown.

History is a view of the current plan, not a log of physical changes or completion times. To edit the plan, return to Mic plot; to add instructions, use Backstage Swaps.

The history window does not provide a separate print action. Use the usual plot and swaps reports for paperwork.

Adjusted handover timing

Handovers follow any timing chosen in Mic Plot. Use **Move to next scene** or **Reset timing** there to adjust an eligible handover within its unassigned gap. Moving a completed handover requires it to be marked complete again at the new timing. Pre-Show collections cannot be moved.

Follow a character instead

To see the mics worn by one character across the show, select their name in Character plot. See Character Mic History.

PLOTTING A SHOW

Character Mic History

Character mic history follows one character through the allocation plan.

Open the history

Open **Character plot** and select the character's name with the information symbol at the left of their row.

This opens a read-only history window. It does not change allocations, the current live scene or completion states.

Allocation ranges

The allocation table shows scene names or ranges and the mic numbers worn by the character.

Consecutive scenes with the same set of mics are grouped. A scene without an allocation breaks the range. If the character has two mics, both are listed; changing that combination starts a new range.

This view follows the character, not all roles played by their actor. Offstage markings do not remove a mic from the history: the character still wears it.

Handovers

The handover list shows the mic, outgoing and incoming wearer or Mic table, and the scene where the change is placed. It includes the character's automatic Pre-Show collection when one exists.

Handovers follow the current allocation plan, actor links and any adjusted handover timing. Actor doubling can mean a character change does not require a physical mic handover.

Editing and sharing

Change allocations in Mic plot and actor links in Production setup. The history is derived from that information; it is not a separate list to maintain.

Viewing history does not require Edit show permission on a remote. The history window has no separate print or export action. Use the Character plot report or an individual actor report for paperwork.

To follow a physical pack instead, use the information button beside its number in Mic plot. See Mic History.

PLOTTING A SHOW

Character Plot

The Character plot shows mic allocations from each character’s perspective.

Characters appear down the left, with scenes across the top.

Reading a cell

A cell shows the number of the mic allocated to that character in the scene.

If no mic is allocated, the app shows a dash.

If the character has multiple mics, the cell shows all relevant mic numbers.

Handovers involving the character appear beneath the allocation.

Handovers

Handover text identifies the mic and the person or destination involved.

A handover can appear in a scene where the character has no allocation. For example, a character may hand over a mic during a blank scene before the next wearer needs it.

The handover’s placement comes from the allocation sequence, rather than from the character’s current cell alone.

See Understanding Handovers.

Editing allocations

Use the **Mic plot** to change allocations.

The Character plot updates from the same show data, so there is no separate character allocation plan to maintain.

Multiple-mic warnings

Red highlighting identifies multiple allocations involving the character or their linked actor.

For example, two different characters may each have one mic but still produce a warning because the same actor plays both.

Use the allocation review controls to mark deliberate multiple-mic arrangements as intentional.

Character order

The row order follows the Characters list in Production setup.

Drag the grips in Production setup, or use its up and down controls, to change the order.

Scrolling

Character names and scene headings remain visible while scrolling through the table.

Search

Use **Edit → Search…** or **Cmd/Ctrl+F**, choose **Actor** or **Character**, and enter a name. Matching entries are highlighted without hiding the rest of the plot. Search carries across plot and Backstage swaps views and does not change printed or exported output. See Search.

Sharing and printing

Use:

- **Export CSV** to save the character plot as a CSV file.
- **Copy table** to copy a table for pasting into another application.
- **File → Print… → Character plot** to print a formatted report.

The copied table uses a simplified layout for sharing. Its formatting differs from the table inside StageMic.

Offstage markings

Click an allocated cell to mark it offstage; click again to clear the mark. Dark blue italic text means the wearer retains the mic but is offstage. The mark is shared between the Character and Actor plots, saved with the show and included in undo/redo. A remote needs **Edit show** permission.

This does not remove the allocation, change the Mic plot or move a handover. Empty and handover-only cells cannot be marked. Printed Character/Actor plots and individual actor reports use grey italics and pale grey shading, with swap/conflict backgrounds taking priority. See Offstage Markings.

Returning to your place

Switching tabs restores this plot's horizontal and vertical scroll positions within the current window. Positions are local to your computer. See Keyboard Navigation for moving between cells without the mouse.

Character mic history

Select a character's name (with the information symbol) at the left of the table to open their allocation ranges and handovers. This is a read-only view. See Character Mic History.

PLOTTING A SHOW

Actor Plot

The Actor plot brings together all the characters played by each actor.

Actors appear down the left, with scenes across the top.

This is likely to be the second most useful view to share with your cast, following the individual reports.

Actor rows

Each actor’s row includes the characters linked to them in Production setup.

Characters without an actor link appear separately, labelled as having no actor assigned.

An actor can appear in the plot even if no characters have been linked to them yet.

Reading a cell

Each allocation shows:

- The mic number.
- The character assigned to that mic.

If an actor plays several characters, their allocations appear in the same row. This lets you follow the person through the show without switching between character rows.

A scene without an allocation shows a dash.

Character changes

An actor changing character while keeping the same mic does not create a physical handover.

Link all of that actor’s characters correctly in Production setup so StageMic can recognise this.

Handovers

Handovers involving any of the actor’s characters appear in their row.

These show the mic number and who it is going to or coming from.

Multiple mics

If an actor has more than one mic in a scene, StageMic highlights the allocation for review.

This can happen when:

- The same character has been allocated several mics.
- Different characters played by the same actor have separate mics.

Correct accidental allocations in the Mic plot. Use **Mark as intentional** for deliberate arrangements such as a main and backup pack.

Editing actor links and order

Use **Settings → Production setup** to:

- Add or rename actors.
- Link characters to actors.
- Reorder actors.

Allocations themselves are edited in the Mic plot.

Scrolling

Actor names and scene headings remain visible while scrolling through the table.

Search

Use **Edit → Search…** or **Cmd/Ctrl+F**, choose **Actor** or **Character**, and enter a name. Matching entries are highlighted without hiding the rest of the plot. Search carries across plot and Backstage swaps views and does not change printed or exported output. See Search.

Scene wearer list

Select **Scene wearer list** beside the export controls, then choose a scene. This selector is for planning and does **not** change the live scene on backstage displays.

The list shows each name once, alphabetically by the displayed name. Linked characters use their actor’s name; characters without an actor link use their character name. Mic numbers are omitted.

Use **Print** in the list window to print it in **portrait**, or save a PDF through the system print dialog. This report is not an option in the main Print modal. Pre-Show is not selectable here.

Sharing and printing

Use **Export CSV** or **Copy table** to share the actor plot.

For printed paperwork:

- **File → Print… → Actor plot** prints the full actor plot.
- **File → Print… → Choose Actors** produces a separate page for each selected actor.

Only actors from the Actors list appear in the individual report picker. Link unassigned characters to actors if you want them included in those reports.

Offstage markings

Click an allocated cell to mark it offstage; click again to clear the mark. Dark blue italic text means the wearer retains the mic but is offstage. The mark is shared between the Character and Actor plots, saved with the show and included in undo/redo. A remote needs **Edit show** permission.

An actor cell toggles all of its allocated characters together. If the actor plays multiple characters in that scene, use Character plot to mark them separately.

This does not remove the allocation, change the Mic plot or move a handover. Empty and handover-only cells cannot be marked. Printed Character/Actor plots and individual actor reports use grey italics and pale grey shading, with swap/conflict backgrounds taking priority. See Offstage Markings.

Returning to your place

Switching tabs restores this plot's horizontal and vertical scroll positions within the current window. Positions are local to your computer. See Keyboard Navigation for moving between cells without the mouse.

PLOTTING A SHOW

Offstage Markings

Offstage markings mean **the wearer keeps the mic but is not onstage**. They describe the allocation without changing it.

Mark an allocation

1. Open **Character plot** or **Actor plot**.
2. Click a cell containing a mic allocation.
3. The allocation becomes dark blue and italic.
4. Click again to return it to the normal appearance.

You can also focus an allocated cell and press Enter or Space. Empty cells and cells containing only handover text cannot be marked.

A Character plot cell marks that character in that scene, including all mics allocated to them. An Actor plot cell marks all allocated characters in that actor's cell together. If several characters in one actor cell need different markings, use Character plot. The actor cell is styled offstage when all its allocated characters are marked.

Shared between views

The mark belongs to the character and scene, so Character and Actor plots stay in sync. It is saved in the show and autosave, supports undo/redo and is shared with collaborators. A remote needs **Edit show** permission to change it.

Renaming or reordering scenes preserves their markings. Splitting a scene copies them to both parts. Renaming a character preserves their markings; removing the character or their final allocation in a scene removes the corresponding mark.

What stays the same

Offstage does not mean unassigned or Mic table. The wearer still has the mic.

- The Mic plot allocation is unchanged.
- Current allocations on backstage displays still show the wearer.
- Handovers, completion tracking and incomplete-handover alerts keep their normal rules.
- A scene wearer list still includes the wearer.

For example, `Lucy (offstage) → Unassigned → Tumnus (offstage)` still places the handover in the unassigned scene, subject to any explicit timing adjustment. The offstage marks do not move it.

Printed reports and exports

Character and Actor plot reports, and individual actor reports, use **grey italic text with pale grey shading**. Yellow handover and red conflict backgrounds take priority. No extra “Offstage” label is added to these cells.

The Mic plot report is unaffected. Character/Actor CSV exports and copied tables do not carry the visual offstage marking.

The DCA picker uses offstage markings to group its characters, and DCA output includes an offstage text annotation.

PLOTTING A SHOW

DCA Plot

The DCA plot is a scene-by-scene programming plan for your mixing console. It links numbered DCAs to **characters**, resolving their mic numbers from the Mic plot.

It does not send commands to the console, change audio levels or alter mic allocations.

Set the number of DCAs

Open **DCA plot**, beside Actor plot. Set **Number of DCAs** to a whole number from **1 to 32**. New shows default to 8.

DCAs use numbers only. Reducing the count removes assignments for the higher-numbered DCAs after confirmation if any are in use. Undo can restore the change.

Rows are DCA numbers and columns are real scenes. Pre-Show is not included.

Assign characters

1. Select a DCA cell for the required scene.
2. Search by character name if needed.
3. Tick the characters to include.
4. Choose **Save**, or **Cancel** to leave the plan unchanged.

Each card shows a character and their allocated mic number or numbers. Search is case-insensitive; selections remain when hidden by the search. The selected count includes those hidden choices.

Multiple characters can belong to one DCA. A character can also belong to more than one DCA in the same scene.

Character groups and order

The picker groups characters as follows:

1. **Mic’d and onstage**
2. **Mic’d but offstage**
3. **No mic allocated**

The first two groups are sorted numerically by mic number. For a character wearing several mics, the lowest mic number determines their position. Characters with no mic are alphabetical.

“Onstage” here means the character has a mic allocation that has not been marked offstage. It is not an automatic scene-breakdown check.

Already assigned characters

Characters in the **Mic’d and onstage** group are dimmed once assigned to any DCA in that scene, including a selection you are currently making.

Dimming is a coverage hint, not a restriction. They remain selectable. The checkbox shows membership in the **DCA being edited**, rather than membership in every DCA.

If you untick someone but they still belong to another DCA in the scene, they remain dimmed. Cancel discards only the changes made in the open picker.

Independent scene plans

Assignments are independent in every scene. There is **no fill-forward**. Selecting characters in one cell does not change later scenes.

Selected characters stay in the plan if their mic allocation changes. The displayed mic number updates from the current Mic plot. A selected character without a mic is labelled **No mic allocated**; this does not create a mic allocation.

Renaming or reordering a scene preserves its DCA plan. Splitting a scene starts both parts with the same DCA assignments. Character renaming preserves membership; removing a character removes it from the plan.

Saving and collaboration

DCA count and memberships are saved in the show and autosave and support undo/redo. Remotes need **Edit show** permission to change them.

Use the same StageMic version on the host and remotes. If another editor changes the DCA plan while you are editing, a conflicting save can be refused; review the latest state before retrying.

Printing and export

- Choose **File → Print… → DCA plot** for a formatted report. Use Scenes per page group to control the width.
- Choose **Export CSV** in DCA plot for a spreadsheet-friendly plan.

The output lists selected characters, their resolved mic numbers, offstage annotations where applicable and characters without a mic. Pre-Show is excluded.

The DCA plot also remembers its scroll position when switching tabs and supports keyboard navigation.

PLOTTING A SHOW

Filling Allocations Forward

Filling forward copies an allocation into following blank scenes.

It is useful when someone keeps the same mic for several scenes or throughout the show.

Using fill forward

In the **Mic plot**:

1. Assign the wearer in the first relevant scene.
2. Press the → button beside that allocation.

StageMic fills the following blank cells on the same mic row.

A brief message confirms how many cells were filled.

Where filling stops

Filling stops before the next existing assignment.

That includes:

- Another character.
- The same character already assigned.
- A Mic table assignment.

It also stops at the end of the show.

Existing allocations are not overwritten.

Example

Before filling:

Mic	Scene 1	Scene 2	Scene 3	Scene 4	Scene 5
1	John	Unassigned	Unassigned	Alice	Unassigned

Pressing → in Scene 1 produces:

Mic	Scene 1	Scene 2	Scene 3	Scene 4	Scene 5
1	John	John	John	Alice	Unassigned

Alice’s existing assignment stops the fill. The blank cell after Alice is left unchanged.

Mic table assignments

Mic table counts as an existing assignment and stops a fill from an earlier scene.

You can also fill a Mic table assignment forward if you want the plot to show the mic remaining at the table across several scenes.

When the button is unavailable

There is nothing to fill forward from an unassigned cell or beyond the final scene, so the button is unavailable in those cases.

After filling

Review the Character and Actor plots for unintended multiple-mic allocations.

Fill forward follows the mic row. It does not check whether the wearer should retain that mic for dramatic or practical reasons.

To correct a filled allocation, edit the affected cells in the Mic plot. Save a separate backup before making substantial changes if you may want to return to the earlier plot.

Undoing a fill

A fill-forward operation is one show edit. Undo reverses the whole fill rather than requiring each affected cell to be cleared separately. Use **Edit → Undo** to reverse a show edit: **Cmd+Z** on macOS or **Ctrl+Z** on Windows. Redo uses **Cmd+Shift+Z** on macOS or **Ctrl+Y** on Windows. Focused text inputs retain their text-editing undo behaviour. See Undo and Redo.

PLOTTING A SHOW

Renaming and Reordering

Use Production setup to rename and reorder scenes, characters and actors.

These controls let you adjust the show without deleting and recreating entries.

Renaming

Edit the name in the relevant row, then press Enter or move focus away to commit the change.

Use clear, recognisable names: these appear in plots, backstage displays and reports.

Character names must remain unique within the show.

Renaming a character

Renaming a character updates its existing allocations.

Its actor link is retained, so you do not need to assign the renamed character to its actor again.

Review intentional multiple-mic approvals after changing character names, because the recorded character allocation has changed.

Renaming an actor

Renaming an actor updates the links from their characters.

Their allocations remain connected through those characters.

Review handover completion states and multiple-mic approvals after changing wearer information.

Renaming a scene

Renaming changes the displayed scene name while retaining its allocations and internal scene identifier.

Its individual scene-specific OSC address stays the same.

Reordering

Drag the grip beside a scene, character or actor to its new position. Each drop is one undoable edit. The ↑ and ↓ buttons remain available as an alternative.

The first entry cannot move up, and the final entry cannot move down.

Character and actor order determines their row order in the corresponding plots and reports.

Reordering scenes

Moving a scene also moves its allocation column.

Scene order affects the chronology of the show, including:

- Next-scene advancement.
- Detected handovers and their timing.
- Numeric OSC scene selection.
- Incomplete-handover alerts.

Review the Backstage swaps list after changing scene order.

OSC cues

Individual scene addresses use stable identifiers, so they remain attached to their scenes after renaming or reordering.

Numeric OSC messages select a scene by its position. Reordering scenes can therefore change what those messages select.

If your show uses numeric cues (`/stagemic/scene X`), check them after changing scene order.

Splitting and OSC

When a scene is split, Part 1 keeps its original stable OSC address and Part 2 receives a new one. Later numeric scene positions shift. Review positional cues after splitting. See Scenes.

Undoing an edit

Use **Edit → Undo** to reverse a show edit: **Cmd+Z** on macOS or **Ctrl+Z** on Windows. Redo uses **Cmd+Shift+Z** on macOS or **Ctrl+Y** on Windows. Focused text inputs retain their text-editing undo behaviour. See Undo and Redo.

Before major revisions

Save a separate `.mic` backup before making extensive changes.

Autosave records the revised show; it does not retain the previous order as a separate version.

Offstage markings and DCA plans

Scene renaming and reordering keep offstage markings and DCA assignments attached to their scene. Renaming a character preserves its markings and DCA memberships. Removing scenes or characters removes the corresponding entries. Review the plan after structural changes.

PLOTTING A SHOW

Clearing Allocations

You can clear a single allocation, clear a mic across the show or start a new blank show.

Choose the smallest change that matches what you want to remove.

Clear one cell

In the **Mic plot**, open the relevant cell’s dropdown and choose the unassigned option.

This removes the character or Mic table assignment from that scene only.

The mic remains available, and its allocations in other scenes are unchanged.

Clear a whole mic

Click the mic’s number on the left of the Mic plot.

After confirmation, StageMic clears that mic’s allocations across every scene.

The numbered mic remains in the show so that you can allocate it again.

Reduce the mic count

If you want to remove physical mic rows from the show:

1. Open **Settings → Production setup**.
2. Enter a lower number of mics.
3. Select **Set mic count** or press Enter.
4. Confirm the reduction.

This removes the highest-numbered mics and their allocations.

Use this when the show genuinely has fewer packs available. Use Clear mic when you want to keep the pack but replot it.

Start a blank show

Choose **File → New**.

StageMic asks whether you want to save the current show before replacing it with a blank one.

See Saving, Autosaving, and Loading.

Clearing is not a return to the table

An unassigned cell leaves the mic's wearer unspecified for that scene.

If you want to record a physical return, choose **Mic table** instead.

Clearing an allocation can change how StageMic detects a handover. A gap between two wearers will cause the handover to move to the first blank scene.

Clearing is not a completion reset

Removing an allocation changes the show plan.

To prepare completion tracking for another performance, use **Reset all completions** in Backstage swaps. You do not need to clear or rebuild allocations.

After clearing

Review the surrounding scenes and Backstage swaps list.

Clearing cells may remove handovers, move their timing or invalidate intentional multiple-mic approvals.

Changes are automatically saved. Keep a separate `.mic` backup before clearing substantial parts of the plot.

Undoing a clear

Clearing one cell, clearing a whole mic or reducing the mic count can be undone as a show edit while that edit remains in history. **New** starts a new history and cannot be undone to recover the previous show. Use **Edit → Undo** to reverse a show edit: **Cmd+Z** on macOS or **Ctrl+Z** on Windows. Redo uses **Cmd+Shift+Z** on macOS or **Ctrl+Y** on Windows. Focused text inputs retain their text-editing undo behaviour. See Undo and Redo.

Keeping allocations before reducing the mic count

The reduction confirmation identifies occupied mics that would be removed. Use Move allocations to transfer work to a mic you are keeping before reducing the count. Shows support a maximum of 50 mics.

PLOTTING A SHOW

Moving Mic Allocations

Move allocations transfers one mic’s entire show row to another mic number and clears the source. Use it when changing pack numbers or rearranging allocations before reducing the mic count.

Move a mic

1. Open **Settings → Production setup**.
2. Select **Move allocations…** beside the mic count.
3. Choose **From mic** and **To mic**.
4. Confirm the move. If the destination already has allocations, StageMic asks before replacing its allocations and notes.

For example, to remove mic 25 while mic 23 is unused, move 24 to 23, then 25 to 24, then reduce the count to 24.

What moves

Allocations across every scene move to the destination. Matching handover notes, including Pre-Show notes, follow them. The source row becomes blank. The destination is replaced; this does not merge two rows.

Completion records for both affected mics are cleared. Review the new handovers before continuing a performance.

Undo and collaboration

The move is one undo step. Use the notification’s **Undo** action or the normal **Edit → Undo** command to restore allocations and notes. Completion ticks are not restored by show-edit undo.

A remote needs **Edit show** permission. StageMic checks both rows against the current shared show before accepting a move, including cells that were blank when you opened the dialog. If another editor changed either row, review their changes and try again.

PLOTTING A SHOW

Backstage Swaps

The Backstage swaps view lists the handovers detected from your mic allocations.

Use it to review the running order of changes and monitor their completion during a performance.

Reading the list

Each handover identifies:

- The mic.

- The outgoing and incoming wearer, or Mic table.
- The scene in which the handover is placed.

The list is sorted chronologically by scene.

A mic can appear several times as it moves between wearers throughout the show.

How timing is determined

StageMic places a handover:

- In the receiving scene when assignments are consecutive.
- In the first unassigned scene after the outgoing wearer when there is a gap.
- At the explicit return or collection point when Mic table is used.

See Understanding Handovers for examples.

Reviewing the plan

Check the list against entrances, exits and the practical time available for each change.

StageMic derives the list from the plot. Offstage markings do not alter handover detection. StageMic does not infer whether there is enough time for a costume change or where the crew will meet the wearer.

To change a detected handover, edit the allocations, actor links or scene structure that produce it.

The swaps list is not a separate allocation plan.

Handover notes

Select **Add note** in a handover's row, enter the instruction and choose **Save**. Use **Edit note** to change it, or clear the text and save to remove it. Notes can contain line breaks and up to 2,000 characters.

The host and remotes with **Completions and swap notes** permission can edit notes. A saved note appears on that handover's card on both Crew and Complete-only displays. Cards without notes do not show an empty note area.

Use notes for practical instructions such as “After Lucy's exit” or “Meet at stage left”. Notes add context; they do not change the handover's timing or completion state.

Notes are saved with the show and autosave, and editing them supports show-edit undo/redo. They follow the same mic, receiving scene and outgoing/incoming characters through scene renames, reordering and splitting where that handover still exists. Renaming a character preserves its notes. Removing or replacing a handover can remove its note, so review notes after substantial plotting changes.

Pre-Show collections

Expand **Pre-Show collections** to inspect the automatic collections for wearers in the first real scene. Its completion buttons work like the other handovers, and its rows also support Add/Edit note. **Reset all completions** resets these collections too.

The section is collapsed by default. It and its collections are excluded from normal printed reports. Use **Export collection list** inside the section to create a separate PDF with paper checkboxes for each performance. See Pre-show Collection List. See Pre-Show.

Marking a handover completed

The status control at the right of each row lets you change its completion state:

- Clicking ○ marks a pending handover completed.
- Clicking ✓ marks a completed handover incomplete.

Completed rows turn green.

Changes are shared with connected backstage displays. The computer controls can correct handovers throughout the show, rather than only those in the current scene.

Resetting before a performance

Select **Reset all completions** and confirm to return the current show’s handovers to pending.

Do this before each performance if you use completion tracking.

Moving between scenes does not reset completion states.

After editing the plot

Changes to a handover’s wearer, actor links or timing can create a new handover identity.

Review completion tracking after substantial plot edits. Before the next performance, reset all completions so that the status reflects that performance.

Completion records are stored on the controlling computer, separately from the `.mic` show file.

Search

Use **Edit → Search…** or **Cmd/Ctrl+F**, choose **Actor** or **Character**, and enter a name. Matching entries are highlighted without hiding the rest of the plot. Search carries across plot and Backstage swaps views and does not change printed or exported output. See Search.

Printing

Choose **File → Print… → Backstage swaps** to print the handover plan.

The printed report includes a **Notes** column only if at least one handover in the report has a note. Pre-Show collections and their notes are never included.

The printed report excludes completion controls, green completion highlighting and live completion counts.

It shows the planned changes rather than progress from a particular performance.

See Handover Completion for backstage display controls.

Collaboration access

Remotes can view the swaps list. **Completions and swap notes** permission enables notes, individual completion corrections and Reset all completions across the show. **Edit show** is separate and is required to change allocations or scene structure. See Permissions.

You can also reset all completions by sending `/stagemic/completions/reset` to the host with no arguments. OSC reset does not show a confirmation dialog.

Moving a mic’s allocations

Move allocations carries matching handover notes, including Pre-Show notes, to the destination mic. Completion records for both affected mics are cleared. Review the resulting swaps and completion states after the move.

Adjusted handover timing

Handovers follow any timing chosen in Mic Plot. Use **Move to next scene** or **Reset timing** there to adjust an eligible handover within its unassigned gap. Moving a completed handover requires it to be marked complete again at the new timing. Pre-Show collections cannot be moved.

Running a Show

Pre-Show

Pre-Show provides initial mic-collection instructions before the first real scene, without adding setup columns to your plot or paperwork.

Automatic collections

For every mic assigned to a character in the **first user-created scene**, StageMic creates a **Mic table → wearer** collection in Pre-Show. Linked actor names appear on display cards in the usual way.

A blank or Mic table allocation in that first scene creates no collection. StageMic does not search later scenes for a mic's first wearer. Editing or reordering the first real scene updates the collections automatically.

You do not need to create an extra Setup or Pre-show scene for this. If an older show already uses manual setup scenes, review their allocations and OSC cues before removing them.

Select Pre-Show

Choose **Pre-Show** at the top of the Current scene dropdown, or send this OSC message without arguments:

```
/stagemic/scene/preshow
```

Pre-Show is **not selected automatically** when StageMic starts. Next from the initial waiting state goes directly to the first real scene. Next from Pre-Show also enters the first real scene.

Numeric OSC scene positions remain unchanged: `/stagemic/scene` with integer `1` selects the first user-created scene. There is no numeric Pre-Show position.

Track collections

Both backstage display types can mark collections completed. Completed Pre-Show cards move below outstanding collections, retaining their order within each group. Crew can undo using the normal controls; Complete-only displays cannot undo. An undone collection returns to the outstanding group. Normal scenes keep their existing card order.

On the computer, expand **Backstage swaps → Pre-Show collections** to inspect or correct individual completions. **Reset all completions** includes these collections; reset before each performance.

If incomplete-handover alerts are enabled, advancing from Pre-Show to the first real scene checks for outstanding collections. See Incomplete Handover Alerts.

During Pre-Show, Current allocations lists mics at Mic table. Collection ticks do not change that list. Select the first real scene to see its plotted wearers.

Display options and collection notes

The display shows a completed count for Pre-Show, just as it does for every other scene. Use **Hide completed** to show only outstanding collections; turn it off to reveal completed cards for review or Crew corrections. **Display size** offers Compact, Standard and Large. These choices apply locally to that display browser. See Display Settings.

On the controlling computer, use **Add note** or **Edit note** within **Backstage swaps → Pre-Show collections** to add collection instructions. They appear on the matching card on both display types. Pre-Show notes are saved with the show but never printed.

Plots and paperwork

Pre-Show is not listed in Production setup or any Mic, Character, Actor or DCA plot. It and its collection handovers are excluded from normal printed reports, individual actor reports, CSV exports, copied tables and mic-label exports. The collapsed section’s heading and controls do not print either.

Collections belong to Pre-Show, never to scene 1. Pre-Show is a live preparation view, not an extra scene in your saved allocation grid.

Preparing from OSC

Send `/stagemic/completions/reset` without arguments to reset the entire show, then `/stagemic/scene/preshow` to display collections. Reset does not select Pre-Show by itself.

A collaboration remote needs Scene control permission to select Pre-Show and Completions and swap notes permission to correct or reset its collections.

Export a paper collection list

Expand **Backstage swaps → Pre-Show collections** and choose **Export collection list**. Enter the number of performances to create a separate PDF with mic, character and actor names, date spaces and empty paper checkboxes. This is an explicit export, not an addition to normal reports. Collection notes and live completion ticks are not included.

See Pre-show Collection List.

RUNNING A SHOW

Selecting and Advancing Scenes

The current scene determines which handovers and mic allocations appear on connected backstage displays.

You can select it manually in StageMic or change it using OSC.

Selecting a scene manually

Choose a scene from the **Current scene** dropdown near the top of the editor.

Connected displays update to show that scene’s:

- Handovers.
- Handover completion states.
- Current mic allocations.

The dropdown displays **Pre-Show**, followed by the scene names entered in Production setup. Pre-Show is not selected automatically when StageMic starts.

Selecting a scene does not change the allocation plan or mark any handovers completed.

Advancing to the next scene

Select **Next scene →** to move forward one scene in production order.

If no scene is selected, the button selects the first real scene, skipping Pre-Show. If Pre-Show is selected, Next advances to the first real scene. At the final scene, it does not advance further.

Each activation advances once. Pressing it twice moves forward twice, so avoid repeated clicks if waiting for a display to update.

Pressing Space when no interactive control is focused and no editor dialog is open also advances to the next scene.

Selecting Pre-Show

Select **Pre-Show** manually or send `/stagemic/scene/preshow` with no arguments. Its collections prepare first-scene wearers before the show. See Pre-Show.

Moving backwards or jumping

Use the dropdown to return to an earlier scene or jump to another part of the show.

Completion states are retained when navigating. Returning to a scene shows its existing ticks; it does not start that scene's handovers again.

Use **Reset all completions** in Backstage swaps before a new performance.

OSC control

StageMic can follow scene messages sent by QLab or another compatible OSC controller.

The next-scene message is:

```
/stagemic/scene/go/next
```

Send it without arguments. It behaves like the Next scene button.

You can also select a specific scene using its individual OSC address. Select the scene in StageMic, then copy its reference message from **Settings → Network setup**.

Individual scene addresses use stable identifiers and remain attached to their scenes when renamed or reordered.

See OSC Dictionary and QLab Integration.

Choosing when to advance

Advance at the point when you want the crew to see the next scene's changes.

For example, a cue at the end of one scene can select the following scene, displaying the handovers needed for the transition.

StageMic uses your scene selection directly. It does not determine whether a dramatic scene has finished or whether every handover has physically happened.

Agree the cue timing with your crew and test it during rehearsal.

Keeping control in sync

If you use next-scene OSC messages, a missed or repeated cue can put StageMic out of sequence.

Use specific scene messages at reference points, such as the start of the show or after the interval. These select the intended scene directly.

You can also correct the current scene manually using the dropdown.

After correcting it, check that the next cue will advance to the expected scene.

Incomplete-handover alerts

If enabled, StageMic checks for pending handovers when moving forward exactly one scene.

Alerts do not block the scene change.

See Incomplete Handover Alerts.

Collaboration

The host and any remote with **Scene control** permission can select or advance the shared current scene. A remote without that permission does not see the dropdown or Next button, and Space cannot advance the host's scene.

Scene control is independent of editing and completion access. Agree who is calling or advancing scenes so that two operators do not advance the same cue twice. Send OSC to the host; remotes pause their own OSC receivers while connected.

RUNNING A SHOW

Incomplete Handover Alerts

StageMic can warn the operator when advancing from a scene with handovers that have not been marked completed.

This is optional. Leave it disabled if your crew do not use completion tracking.

Enabling alerts

In **Settings → Production setup**, enable:

Alert me about handovers not marked complete

The setting is off by default. It is saved in autosave and `.mic` show files, so it travels with the show.

When an alert is triggered

StageMic checks the scene being left when the new scene is immediately after it in production order.

This applies to scene changes made through:

- **Next scene →**.
- The current-scene dropdown.
- OSC, including specific scene messages.

For example, moving from the third scene to the fourth checks for pending handovers in the third scene.

The check uses scene order, not the numbers or words in scene names. Moving from `Opening` to the next scene, `The Station`, qualifies in the same way.

Leaving Pre-Show

When alerts are enabled, moving from **Pre-Show to the first real scene** checks for outstanding Pre-Show collections. Jumping from Pre-Show to a later scene does not trigger this check. Selecting the first real scene from the initial waiting state is still an initial selection and does not alert.

When an alert is not triggered

StageMic does not send an incomplete-handover alert when:

- Selecting a scene for the first time.
- Selecting the current scene again.
- Moving backwards.
- Jumping forward by more than one scene.

This avoids treating navigation and resynchronisation as normal scene advancement.

What the operator sees

If handovers remain pending, StageMic:

- Sends a silent operating-system notification.
- Shows a dismissible warning inside the editor.

The warning groups the pending handovers from the scene being left, using actor names where available.

Scene advancement continues immediately. The notification does not open a confirmation dialog or take focus, and backstage displays move to the new scene.

What a warning means

An alert means a handover was **not marked completed**.

It does not prove that the physical change was missed. Cast/crew may have completed the change without ticking it.

Confirm the situation with the crew before taking action.

Correcting completion status

Select **Mark complete** beside a handover in the in-app warning once you have confirmed it has happened. There is no need to find it in Backstage swaps first. The warning updates as handovers are completed and disappears when none remain pending.

Use **Backstage swaps** or the Crew display to correct an accidental completion. Marking a handover complete does not change the current scene.

Dismissing the warning does not mark its handovers completed.

Notification settings

Operating-system notification permissions and Focus or Do Not Disturb settings can affect whether the notification appears.

If you rely on these alerts, allow StageMic notifications and configure your computer’s notification settings before the performance.

Test notification delivery on the computer you will use for the show.

Before each performance

If you use alerts:

1. Confirm that the setting is enabled for the show.
2. Reset all completions in Backstage swaps.
3. Check that backstage devices are connected.
4. Make sure the cast/crew know how and when to mark handovers completed.
5. Test a pending handover and a normal one-scene advance during setup.

See Handover Completion for the completion workflow.

Collaboration

The host runs the live show and sends the operating-system notification, including when an authorised remote advances the scene. Connected editors receive the shared warning state. A remote needs Edit show permission to change the show’s alert setting and Scene control permission to advance it.

A remote needs **Completions and swap notes** permission to use the warning’s **Mark complete** buttons.

Collaboration

Collaboration Overview

Collaboration lets several licensed StageMic computers work on one active show over a local network.

The **host** owns the shared show. A **remote** connects to it and receives the access approved by the host.

What stays on the host

The host keeps the show and autosave, serves browser-based backstage displays, receives OSC, and stores handover completion records. It must remain running for the shared session to work.

Remote edits are sent to the host and then shared with the other connected computers. This is live work on one show, not background synchronisation between separate show files.

Remotes and backstage displays

Connection	Runs in	Licence	Access
Remote	StageMic desktop app	Valid local session required	View, plus permissions granted by the host
Crew display	Browser	No separate licence	Current-scene handovers, allocations, completion and corrections
Complete-only display	Browser	No separate licence	Current-scene handovers, allocations and marking completed

Remote permissions do not change what a Crew or Complete-only browser link allows.

Getting started

1. Run the same StageMic version on every desktop computer.
2. Choose the computer that will remain the host for the session.
3. Load the show there and enable Collaboration in Settings.
4. Connect from the other computers using File → Connect to Show….
5. Approve each request on the host and select its permissions.

See Hosting a Show, Connecting to a Show and Permissions.

Network and trust

Use a trusted local network that allows communication between devices. Internet access is not required for collaboration itself; normal licensing requirements still apply.

The host advertises its show and computer name for discovery. Approval controls who receives the show, but an advertised computer name is not proof of identity. Collaboration traffic is not encrypted. Do not expose it directly to the internet.

Even a view-only remote receives the shared show and can save a copy or print it. Approve people you trust with the show’s contents.

Session limits

There is no offline editing for remotes, automatic host takeover or remembered approval. Hosting is off when StageMic starts. Creating or loading another show on the host disconnects remotes and disables Collaboration.

If a host becomes unavailable, remotes cannot continue editing that shared session independently. A previously saved copy can be loaded as a separate show after disconnecting.

Version compatibility and updates

Use **v1.18 on the host and every remote**. Its collaboration protocol is incompatible with v1.14 and earlier.

After joining, remotes normally receive changes rather than another full copy of the show on each poll. A full snapshot is still used when joining or when needed to resynchronise. This reduces repeated processing; memory use still depends on the show and activity.

COLLABORATION

Hosting a Show

The host is the computer that keeps the shared show and runs its OSC and backstage-display services.

Enable Collaboration

1. Open the show you want to share.
2. Save a separate backup if needed.
3. Open **Settings… → Collaboration**, or use **Cmd/Ctrl+,** and choose Collaboration.
4. Turn on **Enable Collaboration**.

The page shows addresses that remotes can use if automatic discovery is unavailable. Choose the address reachable on your show network.

Collaboration is disabled each time StageMic starts. Enabling it does not change your display links or OSC destination.

Approve a connection

When a remote requests access, StageMic shows an approval dialog on the host.

Check the computer name, select the required permissions, and choose **Accept**. Choose **Deny** if you do not recognise the request. **View** is always on; the other permissions are independent.

Requests expire if not answered, so ask the remote to reconnect if the request has gone away. See Permissions.

Manage connected remotes

Settings → Collaboration lists connected and pending remotes. Use the switches beside a remote to change its permissions. Removing a remote ends its access; it must request approval again to rejoin.

The list of remotes is separate from **Connected displays** in Network setup. Browser displays do not use collaboration approval.

Keep the session running

Keep the host awake with StageMic open and its network connection available. Other computers cannot take over automatically.

The host continues to save accepted changes to its autosave. Use Save for a separate named copy. Remotes can also Save a Copy without changing the host’s filename.

Stop sharing

Turn off Enable Collaboration or remove individual remotes when they no longer need access. Creating a new show or loading another show also disables Collaboration and disconnects remotes.

Disabling Collaboration does not deactivate licences. The host’s normal show, OSC and backstage-display functions remain its own.

Firewall requirements

Collaboration listens on TCP **8911** on all IPv4 interfaces. Discovery uses UDP **49141** multicast. These are separate from the default display port 8910 and OSC port 9000.

There is no collaboration interface or port picker in v1.18. If discovery is blocked but TCP access is allowed, use Connect by address. See Collaboration Problems.

When a remote leaves

When an approved remote deliberately disconnects, the host shows a brief notification in the bottom-left corner naming that computer. Temporary connection drops do not produce this departure notification.

Use v1.18 on the host and every remote so all editors support the same show features.

Requests while another app is in front

A connection request does not show, restore or focus the StageMic window. On Windows, StageMic requests taskbar attention; on macOS, it requests an informational Dock bounce. Appearance depends on the operating system.

Bring StageMic forward yourself to review the request. Attention is cleared when the editor gains focus, when no requests remain pending, or after the attention timeout. Requests still need approval;

the attention indicator does not grant access.

COLLABORATION

Connecting to a Show

A remote is another computer running StageMic that connects to the host's active show.

Before connecting

- Install the same StageMic version as the host.
- Start a valid licensed StageMic session on this computer.
- Join the same reachable local network.
- Ask the host to turn on Enable Collaboration.

A browser backstage display does not need these steps; see Connecting a Display.

Find the host

1. Choose **File → Connect to Show…**.
2. Select the show discovered on the local network.
3. If it is missing, use the address shown in the host's Settings → Collaboration, for example `192.168.1.10:8911`.
4. Request the connection.

Discovery does not require typing an IP address when the network permits it. It is StageMic's local discovery service; it is not a list of internet-hosted shows.

Save your current show

StageMic asks whether to save your local show before joining. Choose to save and connect, connect without a separate save, or cancel.

Your local autosave is kept while connected. Your computer's own OSC and backstage-display servers pause, because the host serves the shared show.

Wait for approval

The host must accept your request and grant permissions. You cannot edit the shared show while waiting.

If the request is denied or expires, check with the host before trying again. A previous approval is not a permanent invitation.

Confirm the connection

The header turns purple and identifies remote mode and the host. The window title includes **REMOTE**. Check that the production name and allocations match the intended show.

The host decides which editing and live controls are available. See Working as a Remote.

Leave

Select **Disconnect** in the header or **File → Disconnect from Show**. Choose Cancel to stay connected or Disconnect to return to your local show. Accepted changes remain on the host.

Use Save a Copy first if you want a separate local copy of the shared show.

Version compatibility

The host and remotes must all run v1.18. Its collaboration protocol is not compatible with v1.14 or earlier; update every desktop computer before starting the session.

COLLABORATION

Permissions

The host grants each remote independent permissions when accepting its request. They can be changed later in **Settings → Collaboration**.

View is always enabled and its switch cannot be turned off. To remove all access, disconnect the remote.

Permission	Allows
View	Browse the shared plots and swaps, inspect character history, search locally, print/export and save a copy.
Edit show	Change allocations, offstage markings, DCA assignments/count, characters, actors, scenes, mic count, approvals and show settings.
Completions and swap notes	Complete or undo handovers, reset all completions and add or edit swap notes.
Scene control	Select a scene and advance to the next scene.

Independent switches

The permissions do not form a ladder. You can grant Scene control without editing or completion access, or allow someone to manage completions without changing the plot.

Edit show alone does not grant the swap-note editor or completion controls. **Completions and swap notes** does not grant allocation or scene-structure editing. An authorised plot edit can still change which handovers and notes remain relevant.

Examples:

- A reviewer: View only.
- A mic-table operator: View and Completions and swap notes.

- A stage manager advancing cues: View and Scene control, with completion access if needed.
- A plotting assistant: View and Edit show, with notes access if they need it.

Hidden and disabled controls

Without Scene control, the remote does not see the current-scene dropdown or Next button. Keyboard shortcuts cannot bypass permissions.

Read-only plot and setup controls remain available for viewing but cannot change the show. If the connection is lost, shared editing and live actions are disabled even when permission was previously granted.

Host-only actions

Only the host manages collaboration requests, changes remote permissions and configures the shared show’s network services or Crew password.

New and Load are unavailable on a connected remote. Its Save a Copy command does not replace the host’s active show.

Access is not copy protection

An approved remote can save or print the show with View access. Use permissions to divide responsibilities, and only approve computers you trust.

These permissions govern StageMic desktop remotes. Crew browser access, Complete-only links and the OSC receiver have their own access rules.

Moving allocations

Edit show allows a remote to move a whole mic’s allocations. Existing matching handover notes move with those allocations. Editing note text separately still requires **Completions and swap notes** permission.

Completions and swap notes also allows marking handovers complete directly from an in-app incomplete-handover warning.

Moving or resetting a handover’s scene in Mic plot requires **Edit show** permission. **Completions and swap notes** alone does not allow timing changes.

COLLABORATION

Working as a Remote

Remote mode keeps the shared show in the main StageMic interface. The purple header and **REMOTE** window title distinguish it from your local show.

Viewing and searching

Switch between Mic plot, Character plot, Actor plot, DCA plot and Backstage swaps normally. Search highlights are local to your computer and do not affect anyone else.

Coloured circles on tabs show where connected editors are working. Hover over a circle to see its computer name. These show the selected view, not a live cursor or a lock on a particular cell.

Editing together

With Edit show permission, changes are sent to the host and shared with other remotes.

Edits to different allocation cells can be combined. If two editors change the same information from different starting states, the host rejects a conflicting edit rather than silently overwriting another person’s change. The remote resynchronises with the host; review the current result before trying again.

Scene reordering, character changes and other structural edits affect more than one cell. Coordinate these changes with the other editors to reduce conflicts.

Undo and redo

Undo and redo apply to your own accepted edits. They do not undo another editor’s most recent action.

The host checks whether reversing the edit would conflict with later changes. If it would, the undo is refused. Current permissions apply to undo as well as new edits.

See Undo and Redo.

Completions and notes

With Completions and swap notes permission, use Backstage swaps to correct completion states throughout the show, reset them, and edit notes. Changes update the host, other remotes and browser displays.

Completion actions are separate from show-edit undo. Use the handover’s status control to correct a completion.

Scene control

With Scene control permission, the dropdown and Next button affect the host’s live scene and its displays. Agree who is advancing the show; two Next commands can advance twice.

Remotes do not receive OSC for the shared show. Send OSC to the host.

Settings

Cmd/Ctrl+, opens Production setup for the shared show. Editing requires Edit show permission. Network setup and Collaboration management are available only on the host.

Connection loss

The header indicates the lost connection and shared editing and live actions are disabled. StageMic attempts to reconnect after a brief interruption.

Do not treat the last displayed snapshot as confirmation of the current state while disconnected. After reconnecting, check any action whose result was uncertain before repeating it.

If the host removes you or the session expires, request access again. See Collaboration Problems.

Receiving other editors' changes

Updates can take a short moment to arrive. If you are using an input, selecting an allocation or working in a dialog, StageMic defers the show redraw until you finish or move focus away. This protects your focus and scroll position while another editor makes changes. Live scene and completion updates are handled separately.

Incoming allocation changes receive a subtle temporary outline in the plots. They do not scroll the view or move your focus. An edit to the same information can still be refused if another editor changed it first; check the current value and try again.

Offstage markings, DCAs and local views

Edit show permission is required to change offstage markings, DCA assignments or the number of DCAs. These changes are shared and saved on the host. Coordinate DCA edits when working simultaneously; a conflicting edit may need to be retried after resynchronising.

Plot scroll positions and search remain local to each computer. Character mic history and the pre-show collection PDF are read-only actions and do not require Edit show permission.

COLLABORATION

Saving and Leaving a Shared Show

Collaboration keeps one active show on the host. It does not replace every remote's local show or synchronise separate saved files.

Host saving

The host autosaves accepted edits from all editors. The host should use **Save** to write a separate `.mic` copy for backups or transfer.

The host also holds live completion records. Those records are stored separately from the show file.

Remote Save a Copy

Save a Copy writes the current shared show to a file on the remote computer. It is available with View access.

It includes the plot, show settings, notes and intentional multiple-mic approvals. It does not contain live completion records, permissions, the host’s network settings, Crew password or licence.

Saving a copy does not change the host’s saved filename or replace the remote’s own autosave.

Disconnecting voluntarily

Use **Disconnect** in the purple header or **File → Disconnect from Show**.

StageMic asks for confirmation:

- **Cancel** leaves you connected.
- **Disconnect** returns you to the local show you had before joining.

Changes already accepted by the host remain there. Disconnecting does not undo your work. The remote’s own network services restart for its local show; check its scene selection before using its displays.

Continuing independently

If you want to continue working on the shared plot after leaving:

1. Save a Copy while connected.
2. Disconnect and confirm.
3. Load the saved copy as your local show.

This is now a separate show copy. Later edits are not sent back automatically, and reconnecting does not merge those independent changes.

Host ends the session

The host can remove a remote or disable Collaboration. New or Load on the host also ends collaboration for the old show.

A disconnected remote cannot keep editing the old shared session. Return to your local show or reconnect after the host enables Collaboration and approves you again.

There is no automatic host migration. Plan a separate saved copy and new display/OSC destinations if you need to move the show to another controlling computer.

When you deliberately disconnect, the host receives a brief notification naming your computer. Your remote undo history is released when you leave; it is not restored by reconnecting.

Backstage Displays

Connecting a Display

Backstage displays run in a web browser. They do not need a separate app or StageMic licence.

The controlling computer must remain running with StageMic open while displays are in use.

Connect to the network

Connect the controlling computer and display devices to a network that allows them to communicate.

Wi-Fi, Ethernet or a combination of both can be used. Devices do not need to use the same connection method.

Guest networks and networks with client isolation may prevent connections, even when devices appear to be on the same Wi-Fi.

Open Settings → Network setup

In StageMic, open **Settings → Network setup**.

The **Backstage displays** section contains the display server settings and links for the available displays.

The default display server settings are:

Setting	Default
Interface	All interfaces (`0.0.0.0`)
Port	`8910`

`0.0.0.0` is a listening setting, rather than an address to enter on another device. Use one of the display links shown by StageMic.

If several network addresses are listed, choose the one reachable from your backstage devices.

Open a display

Choose the display type you want to use, then either:

- Copy its link into the device’s browser.
- Select **QR code** and scan the code with the device.
- Select **Open** to preview it in the controlling computer’s default browser.

Crew displays require the Crew password. Complete-only displays open without a password.

See Types of Display.

Set the Crew password

Before using Crew displays:

1. Select **Change crew password** beneath the Crew link.
2. Enter the password.
3. Select **Save**.
4. Enter that password on each Crew display when prompted.

Changing the password signs out existing Crew sessions. Complete-only displays are unaffected.

The password belongs to the controlling computer and is not included in `.mic` show files.

Check the connection

Select a scene in StageMic.

Confirm that the display shows the correct scene, handovers and current allocations. If you use completion tracking, test that a completion appears on the computer and other connected displays.

The display’s connection banner indicates whether it is receiving updates from StageMic.

Reusing links

Display links remain the same while the controlling computer’s address and configured display port remain unchanged.

You can bookmark them for later use. A changed IP address, network interface or port may require a new link.

Crew browsers can remember a successful login. Clearing cookies, using private browsing, an expired login or changing the Crew password can require another login.

During a performance

Keep the display visible and the device awake.

Browsers may suspend background tabs, and devices may disconnect when locked or asleep. On returning, check the connection banner and current scene before relying on the display.

A disconnected display may still show information from its last successful update.

If the display will not connect

Check that:

- StageMic is open and its display server is running.
- You are using a reachable address from Network setup.
- The devices can communicate across the network.
- The controlling computer’s firewall allows incoming connections.
- The link uses the configured display port.

Use a trusted backstage network. Do not expose the display server directly to the internet.

See Display Connection Problems.

Check the connection and adjust the layout

On the controlling computer, **Settings → Network setup → Connected displays** lists connected display tabs and their types, browser/platform and addresses.

On the display, choose **Display size** and **Hide completed** below the connection banner. Preferences are remembered in that browser. See Display Settings.

Collaboration

Use the display links on the **host** in Settings → Network setup. A remote is another licensed desktop editor, not a browser display, and does not host displays for the shared show. The browser display roles and Crew password are independent of remote permissions.

BACKSTAGE DISPLAYS

Types of Display

StageMic provides two backstage display types: **Crew** and **Complete-only**.

Both show the same live scene information. Their completion permissions differ.

Display	Mark completed	Undo completion	Password
Crew	Yes	Yes	Required
Complete-only	Yes	No	Not required

Neither display can edit the mic plot or advance the current scene.

Shared information

Both display types show:

- The selected scene.
- Handovers for that scene.
- Shared handover completion states and a completed count for the scene.
- Handover notes added on the controlling computer, where present.
- Current mic allocations.
- Connection status.

Actor names are shown where characters have been linked to actors in Production setup.

The controlling computer selects the scene manually or through OSC.

Crew display

The Crew display is available at the `/crew` link shown in Network setup.

It requires the Crew password and allows users to:

- Mark a handover completed.
- Undo a recent completion.
- Deliberately reset a completed handover using the hold-to-undo control.

Use it for crew who need to correct completion states from their backstage device.

Browsers can remember a successful login for up to one year. Changing the Crew password invalidates existing logins.

The Crew password is a deterrent, not a security method. Determined attackers may be able to bypass it, so keep the network isolated and only allow authorised devices to access it.

Complete-only display

The Complete-only display is available at the `/display` link.

It allows users to mark pending handovers completed, but does not allow them to undo a completion.

Use it where someone needs to contribute completion updates without being able to reset completed changes.

It _is_ an interactive display, rather than a read-only one.

Access and network reachability

The Complete-only display has no password. Any device that can reach it can use its permitted completion controls.

Crew access is password-protected, but the local HTTP connection is not encrypted.

Use both displays on a trusted backstage network and share the Crew password only with authorised users.

Computer controls

The controlling computer can correct individual completion states in **Backstage swaps**, regardless of which display marked them completed.

It also provides **Reset all completions** before the next performance.

See Handover Completion.

Pre-Show collections

Both display types show Pre-Show collection cards when the operator selects Pre-Show. Completed cards move below outstanding collections; ordinary scenes keep their existing order. Completion permissions remain as shown above. See Pre-Show.

Display layout

Both types provide **Display size** and a **Hide completed** switch at the top right below the connection banner, alongside the show and display information. These settings affect presentation only and do not change completion permissions. See Display Settings.

BACKSTAGE DISPLAYS

Display Settings

Each backstage display can use its own size and completed-card visibility settings. Both Crew and Complete-only displays offer the same layout controls.

Find the controls

Display size and **Hide completed** are at the top right below the connection banner. The show name and display information occupy the left half of the same header row. Controls can wrap within their half on narrower screens.

Display size

Choose **Compact**, **Standard** or **Large**. Standard is the default.

Compact reduces card spacing and text sizes so more handovers can fit on screen. Large gives names and controls more room. Choose a size that remains comfortable to read from the position where the display will be used.

Actor and character names resize as whole names to fit their available space. They can wrap between words; very long unbroken names shrink further rather than using a text scrollbar or splitting mid-word.

Hide completed

Turn on **Hide completed** to remove completed cards from that display's list. Turn it off to reveal them again. The number beside the switch shows how many handovers are completed in the current scene.

Hiding completed cards does not reset them, change another display's settings or alter completion permissions. A Complete-only display still cannot undo a completion. On a Crew display, reveal a completed card before using its hold-to-undo control; the brief Undo button also remains available after completing a handover.

When every handover is completed and hidden, the display shows a message explaining how to reveal them.

Progress

Every selected scene shows a count such as **8 of 12 completed**, including hidden completed handovers. A scene with no handovers shows zero of zero and its usual no-handovers message.

In Pre-Show, completed cards move below outstanding collections when visible. Ordinary scenes retain their existing order. See Handover Completion.

Remembered preferences

Size and Hide completed are saved in the display browser's local storage, not in the `.mic` show file. They apply across scenes and shows opened from the same display-server address in that browser.

Different devices or browsers can use different settings. Clearing browser storage, changing the server address or port, or using private browsing can reset them. If browser storage is unavailable, settings still work for the current page but may not survive a reload.

BACKSTAGE DISPLAYS

Current Allocations

The **Current allocations** section shows who is plotted to have each mic in the selected scene.

It is available on both Crew and Complete-only backstage displays.

Reading the list

Each entry identifies the mic and its assigned character. Actor information is included where the character has been linked to an actor in Production setup.

Mic table assignments identify packs plotted at the table.

Unassigned mics have no specified wearer for that scene.

During Pre-Show

Pre-Show has collection cards rather than a normal allocation column. During Pre-Show, **Current allocations** lists the mics at **Mic table**. Marking collections completed does not change that list. Use the collection cards to track fitting progress; selecting the first real scene shows its plotted wearers.

Finding a wearer

Current allocations can help crew locate the person associated with a pack.

For example, if the operator reports that mic 12 needs a battery change:

1. Check the display’s current scene.
2. Find mic 12 in Current allocations.
3. Identify the listed actor or character.
4. Confirm their location and arrange the battery change.

Accurate actor links make this easier when an actor plays several characters.

Planned allocations

Current allocations comes from the show plot.

It does not receive live information from radio transmitters or receivers, and it does not track a pack’s physical location.

Marking a handover completed does not change this list. An unticked handover also does not prevent the list from showing the receiving wearer once that scene is selected.

If a handover has been missed or the plan has changed, confirm the actual wearer with the crew.

Scene changes

The list updates when the controlling computer changes the current scene.

Moving backwards or jumping to another scene shows the allocations plotted for that scene.

If the list looks unexpected, check the scene name and connection status before assuming the plot is wrong.

Multiple mics

If someone is allocated more than one mic, each pack remains listed independently.

Marking a multiple-mic allocation as intentional does not combine the packs or hide either entry.

Correcting allocations

Allocations cannot be edited from a backstage display.

Make changes in the controlling computer’s **Mic plot**. Connected displays then receive the updated show information.

BACKSTAGE DISPLAYS

Handover Completion

Completion tracking lets crew mark physical handovers as done.

The status is shared across connected backstage displays and the controlling computer.

Marking a handover completed

On a Crew or Complete-only display, select **Mark completed** on the relevant handover.

After StageMic confirms the change:

- The handover turns green, or disappears from that display if Hide completed is on.
- Its status shows **Completed**.
- Other connected displays update.
- The corresponding row in Backstage swaps turns green.

Mark the handover when the physical change has happened, according to your crew’s agreed workflow.

Each handover has its own status. A return to the table and a later collection are separate changes.

Progress and hiding completed cards

Every selected scene shows a completed count, for example **8 of 12 completed**. This includes completed handovers even when their cards are hidden. It records completion ticks, not independent confirmation that the physical changes happened.

Turn on **Hide completed** to focus on outstanding handovers. The setting is local to that display browser; other displays can keep all cards visible. When all are complete, a message explains how to reveal them. Turn the switch off to inspect a completed card or use Crew's hold-to-undo control.

Hiding a card never resets its status. See Display Settings.

Undoing on a Crew display

Crew displays offer an **Undo** button briefly after marking a handover completed.

After that button disappears, hold the completed handover’s button to mark it incomplete. A normal short tap does not undo it.

When using keyboard activation, StageMic asks for confirmation instead of requiring a pointer hold.

These controls help prevent accidental resets while still allowing corrections. Completion buttons prevent text selection and the long-press callout on iPhone Safari, so holding the button operates the undo control.

Complete-only displays

Complete-only displays can mark pending handovers completed.

They cannot undo a completion. Ask someone with a Crew display or access to the controlling computer to correct a mistake.

Correcting from the computer

In **Backstage swaps**, use the status control at the right of a row:

- Clicking ○ marks it completed.
- Clicking ✓ marks it incomplete.

These controls work throughout the show, including handovers outside the currently selected scene.

Changes are shared with connected displays.

Pre-Show ordering

In **Pre-Show only**, completed cards move below outstanding collections on both display types. Within each group, cards retain their original order. Undoing a collection returns it to the outstanding group. Ordinary scenes retain their original card order.

The computer’s collapsed **Pre-Show collections** section provides individual corrections. **Reset all completions** includes these collections.

Completion Undo is separate from the editor’s show-edit undo/redo history. Show-edit undo does not reverse completion ticks.

Disconnected displays

Completion controls are disabled while a display is disconnected.

Actions are not queued for automatic submission later.

If a request times out, check the handover’s status after reconnection before trying again. The computer may have accepted the change even if the device did not receive the confirmation.

Moving between scenes

Completion states remain when you move forwards, backwards or jump between scenes.

Returning to a scene does not reset its handovers.

Devices that reconnect receive the current shared status.

Resetting for another performance

On the controlling computer:

1. Open **Backstage swaps**.
2. Select **Reset all completions**.
3. Confirm the reset.

This returns the current show’s handovers to pending and updates connected displays.

Reset before each performance if you use completion tracking. Restarting StageMic does not perform this reset automatically.

Storage and show edits

Completion records are stored locally on the controlling computer, separately from `.mic` show files.

They persist across application restarts but do not travel with a show file to another computer.

Editing the wearer, actor links or timing of a handover can change its identity. Review completion states after substantial plot changes.

Allocations and paperwork

Completion tracking records progress; it does not edit the allocation plan.

Current allocations continues to show the plotted wearer for the selected scene.

Completion ticks and green progress highlighting are excluded from printed reports, CSV exports and copied plot tables.

Optional alerts

StageMic can warn the operator when advancing from a scene with handovers still pending.

See Incomplete Handover Alerts.

Collaboration and OSC

Remotes with **Completions and swap notes** permission can complete, undo and reset handovers throughout the show from Backstage swaps. Their actions update the host and all connected displays. Remotes without this permission can view completion states.

To reset from show control, send `/stagemic/completions/reset` to the host with no arguments. It resets every handover, including Pre-Show, without changing the scene or allocations. There is no confirmation for an OSC reset. Use it deliberately before a performance.

Completing from an alert

When an incomplete-handover warning appears in the editor, use **Mark complete** beside each change after checking with the crew. The warning follows shared completion status and disappears once all its handovers are complete. Remotes require **Completions and swap notes** permission. Dismissing a warning does not complete anything.

Moving allocations between mics clears completion records for the two affected mics. Review them before continuing a performance.

Adjusted handover timing

Handovers follow any timing chosen in Mic Plot. Use **Move to next scene** or **Reset timing** there to adjust an eligible handover within its unassigned gap. Moving a completed handover requires it to be marked complete again at the new timing. Pre-Show collections cannot be moved.

Networking

Network Setup

StageMic’s Network setup controls three services:

- A **display server** for browser-based backstage displays.
- An **OSC receiver** for scene control.
- Collaboration

Their interfaces and ports can be configured independently in **Settings → Network setup**.

Default settings

Service	Interface	Port	Protocol
Backstage displays	All interfaces (`0.0.0.0`)	`8910`	HTTP over TCP
OSC control	Localhost (`127.0.0.1`)	`9000`	OSC over UDP

These settings allow displays to connect over the local network while keeping OSC control on the controlling computer by default.

Choosing an interface

An interface determines where a service listens for connections or messages.

All interfaces

All interfaces (`0.0.0.0`) listens on the computer’s available IPv4 interfaces.

This can be useful when devices connect through different network connections, such as Wi-Fi and Ethernet.

`0.0.0.0` is a listening setting. Do not enter it as the destination address on another device. Use the controlling computer’s reachable address.

A specific interface

Select a listed address to restrict the service to that interface.

For example, you could serve backstage displays over Ethernet while receiving OSC through another network connection.

Interface names and addresses depend on the computer and its current connections.

Localhost

Localhost (`127.0.0.1`) is available for OSC.

It accepts messages sent from software running on the same computer. Use this when QLab and StageMic run together.

Localhost is not offered for the display server, because other devices cannot reach it.

Ports

A port identifies the service on the computer.

Keep the defaults unless another application uses them or your network requires different settings.

If you change a port, update the corresponding display links or OSC controller configuration.

The display port and OSC port serve different purposes. Send OSC to the configured UDP port, rather than to the browser display address.

Applying changes

1. Choose the required interfaces.
2. Enter the ports.
3. Select **Apply network settings**.
4. Confirm the change.

Applying settings briefly pauses OSC reception and reconnects displays. Make changes during setup rather than during a performance.

The current scene and completion records are retained.

If the new settings cannot be used, StageMic attempts to restore the previous settings.

Refreshing interfaces

Select **Refresh interfaces** after connecting Ethernet, joining another network or otherwise changing the computer’s connections.

If a previously saved interface is unavailable, StageMic leaves the editor available so you can select a replacement.

Display links

StageMic generates links for the display interface and port you have chosen.

When listening on all interfaces, it may show several addresses. Choose the address reachable from your backstage devices.

Use **Open** to preview a display or **QR code** to connect another device.

See Connecting a Display.

Connected displays

The **Connected displays** table beneath the display links lists each active display connection. Its columns show the display type (Crew or Complete-only), browser/platform and network address.

Each open display tab is a separate connection, so one device can appear more than once. Connections appear and disappear as tabs connect, close or reconnect. This list is shown only on the controlling computer.

Firewalls and network isolation

Allow StageMic’s incoming connections if your firewall asks.

A network can allow internet access while preventing devices from communicating with each other. Guest Wi-Fi and client isolation commonly cause this.

Ask the venue’s network administrator for a suitable connection if devices cannot communicate.

Stable addresses

Display bookmarks and OSC destinations depend on the controlling computer’s address.

If the network assigns a different address, update those links and destinations. A DHCP reservation arranged with the network administrator can help keep the address consistent.

Storage

Network settings are saved on the controlling computer.

They are not included in `.mic` files. Loading another show does not replace them, and moving a show to another computer does not transfer them.

Network security

Use a trusted show network.

Backstage displays use unencrypted HTTP. The Complete-only display has no password, and OSC scene control has no authentication.

Do not expose these services directly to the internet.

Collaboration service

Open **Settings → Collaboration** on the host to enable shared editing. This uses a separate TCP service on port **8911**, listening on all IPv4 interfaces, and UDP **49141** for discovery. These are not the display or OSC ports and are not configurable in Network setup in v1.18.

Only the host serves the shared show’s backstage displays and receives OSC. A remote pauses its own services while connected and does not show Network setup. See Hosting a Show.

Unapplied changes

Closing Settings with unapplied network changes offers **Save**, **Discard** or **Cancel**. Save applies the draft before closing. If it fails, Settings stays open. Discard leaves the existing network configuration in place; Cancel returns to the draft. Live status updates do not replace your unsaved entries.

NETWORKING

OSC Dictionary

StageMic accepts OSC messages over **UDP** to select or advance the current scene and reset handover completions.

The default destination is:

Setting	Default
Address	`127.0.0.1`
UDP port	`9000`

The address above applies when the controller runs on the same computer. For another computer, use StageMic’s reachable network address and configure its OSC interface accordingly.

Message summary

OSC address	Arguments	Action
`/stagemic/completions/reset`	None	Reset all completions, including Pre-Show.
`/stagemic/scene/go/next`	None	Advance one scene.
`/stagemic/scene/preshow`	None	Select Pre-Show collections.
`/stagemic/scene/{scene-id}`	None	Select a scene by its stable identifier.
`/stagemic/scene`	One integer	Select a scene by its position, starting at 1.
`/stagemic/scene`	One string containing a scene ID	Select a scene by its stable identifier.

Replace `{scene-id}` with an actual identifier. Do not include the braces.

Advance one scene

```
/stagemic/scene/go/next
```

Send without arguments.

- If no scene is selected, StageMic selects the first real scene, skipping Pre-Show.
- From Pre-Show, it advances to the first real scene.
- Otherwise, it advances one scene in production order.
- At the final scene, it does not advance further.

- If the show contains no scenes, it cannot advance.

Each received message advances once. Sending the message twice advances twice where enough scenes remain.

Select Pre-Show

```
/stagemic/scene/preshow
```

Send without arguments. Pre-Show is a built-in scene and is not selected automatically. It has no numeric scene position: integer `1` still selects the first user-created scene.

Select a scene by stable identifier

```
/stagemic/scene/{scene-id}
```

Send without arguments.

To obtain the exact message:

1. Select the required scene in StageMic.
2. Open **Settings → Network setup**.
3. Copy **Reference point for the current scene**.

Scene identifiers remain attached to scenes when renamed or reordered. Splitting preserves the original identifier on Part 1 and creates a new identifier for Part 2. Later numeric positions shift.

Deleting a scene and creating a replacement produces a different identifier. Use the message from the show file you intend to run.

Alternative argument form

You can also send:

```
/stagemic/scene
```

with one OSC string argument containing the scene identifier.

Both forms select the scene directly.

Select a scene by position

Send:

```
/stagemic/scene 3
```

Here, `/stagemic/scene` is the address and `3` is an OSC **integer** argument.

This selects the third scene in production order, regardless of its displayed name.

Scene numbering starts at **1** for the first real scene. Pre-Show is not numbered and is not selected with `0`.

Reordering, inserting or removing scenes can change which scene a numeric message selects. Stable scene identifiers are preferable for programmed reference cues.

A string such as `"3"` is treated as a scene identifier, rather than converted to the third scene. Use an integer argument for positional selection.

Scene names

Displayed scene names are not OSC identifiers.

For example, naming a scene `Opening` does not create an address of `/stagemic/scene/Opening`.

Copy the generated reference message from Network setup.

Timing and bundles

StageMic accepts individual OSC messages and immediate OSC bundles.

Scheduled bundles with future timetags are not supported. Schedule the cue in your controller and send the message when it should take effect.

Messages within an immediate bundle are processed in order. Avoid placing duplicate next-scene messages in the same bundle.

Errors

An unknown identifier, out-of-range scene number or invalid message does not select a new scene.

StageMic records OSC activity and errors in its network status information. It does not send an OSC acknowledgement or scene-status reply to the controller.

Check the current scene in StageMic or on a connected display when testing.

Completion and alerts

OSC scene selection does not mark handovers completed or reset completion tracking.

If incomplete-handover alerts are enabled, an OSC change moving forward exactly one scene checks the scene being left. Jumps, backward moves, repeated selection and initial selection do not trigger that check.

Transport and access

Send properly encoded OSC packets over UDP. Plain text sent to the UDP port is not an OSC message.

OSC control has no password or authentication. Restrict access through your chosen interface and trusted network.

Reset all completions

```
/stagemic/completions/reset
```

Send without arguments. This resets all completion records for the current show, including Pre-Show collections, and updates connected displays and remotes. It clears the current incomplete-handover warning without changing the selected scene, allocations or notes.

Unlike the reset button, OSC reset has no confirmation dialog. Place it in a deliberate pre-performance cue, rather than every scene cue.

Collaboration host

Send OSC to the host’s configured interface and UDP port. Remotes pause their own OSC and display servers while connected. A remote’s Scene control permission governs its app controls, not access to the host’s unauthenticated OSC receiver.

NETWORKING

QLab Integration

QLab can send OSC messages to StageMic alongside your lighting, sound and other show cues. This can allow you to keep your entire show in sync, rather than relying on multiple GO buttons.

A common approach is to advance StageMic at the end of each scene, with specific scene cues at reference points to keep the systems synchronised.

Configure StageMic

If QLab and StageMic run on the same Mac, use:

StageMic setting	Value
OSC interface	Localhost (`127.0.0.1`)
OSC port	`9000`

These are the defaults.

If QLab runs on another computer, select a reachable interface or **All interfaces** in StageMic. Use the StageMic computer’s network address as QLab’s destination.

Create a QLab network patch

In QLab 5, open **Workspace Settings → Network** and configure a patch for StageMic.

Set it to send **OSC messages over UDP** to the StageMic address and port. QLab Network cues use the selected patch to determine where and how messages are sent.

For both apps on the same Mac:

Patch setting	Value
Destination address	`127.0.0.1`
Destination port	`9000`
Transport	UDP
Message type	OSC

Give the patch a recognisable name, such as **StageMic**.

Use the port configured in StageMic, rather than QLab’s own incoming OSC port.

Create a next-scene cue

Create a **Network cue** and select your StageMic patch.

Enter this OSC message:

```
/stagemic/scene/go/next
```

Send it without arguments.

Give the cue a clear name, such as:

> StageMic GO

Each time the cue fires, StageMic advances once.

Place the cue in your sequence

Place the StageMic cue at the point when the crew should see the next scene’s handovers.

For example, include it in an existing end-of-scene sequence so that the next scene’s changes appear during the transition.

Agree this timing with your backstage crew. A cue placed too early can replace information they still need; a cue placed too late can delay the change instructions.

Add reference cues

Next-scene cues depend on StageMic already being on the expected scene.

Add specific scene cues at useful reference points, such as:

- The start of the show.
- The start of the second half.
- Selected checkpoints within each half.

To create one:

1. Select the intended scene in StageMic.
2. Open **Settings → Network setup**.
3. Copy **Reference point for the current scene**.
4. Paste that message into a QLab Network cue using the StageMic patch.
5. Give the cue a name identifying the scene.

These cues select the intended scene directly, regardless of StageMic’s previous position.

Pre-Show cue

Add an optional setup Network cue sending `/stagemic/scene/preshow` with no arguments. This shows first-scene mic collections before the performance.

Once Pre-Show is selected, the next-scene cue enters the first real scene. Keep a specific opening-scene reference cue if you want to establish that scene regardless of StageMic's current position. Pre-Show does not change numeric scene positions.

Establish the opening state

A next-scene message selects the first scene only when no scene is currently selected.

If StageMic is already showing another scene from rehearsal or setup, it advances from there.

Use a specific scene cue to establish the opening scene reliably.

Avoid duplicate advances

Check that each transition sends the next-scene message only once.

A duplicate Network cue, repeated trigger or cue fired manually as well as automatically can advance StageMic twice.

Using specific scene cues at reference points helps recover from a missed or repeated advance.

Rehearsal and navigation

Jumping around in QLab does not automatically select the corresponding StageMic scene. StageMic changes only when it receives a supported message or someone changes it manually.

When starting a rehearsal section:

1. Select the appropriate scene in StageMic, manually or with a reference cue.
2. Confirm the backstage display.
3. Continue with the normal cue sequence.

Test before the performance

Check that:

1. The QLab patch points to the correct computer and UDP port.
2. A reference cue selects the intended scene.
3. A next-scene cue advances exactly once.
4. Backstage displays follow the change.
5. Any incomplete-handover alerts behave as expected.

Save the StageMic show before programming scene-specific cues, and keep that show file with the production's cue documentation.

For the full message reference, see OSC Dictionary.

Reset completions before a performance

A pre-show cue can send these messages, both without arguments:

```
/stagemic/completions/reset
/stagemic/scene/preshow
```

Send reset first, then select Pre-Show. If desired, schedule a short delay between the messages in QLab. Reset has no StageMic confirmation dialog and includes all scenes, so keep it out of normal next-scene cues.

When using Collaboration, the OSC destination is always the host computer. If QLab runs on a remote computer, localhost points to that remote, not the host; use the host’s reachable address and suitable OSC interface.

Printing and Sharing

Print Reports

StageMic produces formatted reports for printing or saving as PDFs through the system print dialog.

Reports use a separate layout from the editor, with readable headings and allocation tables.

Opening the print controls

Choose **File → Print…**, or press **Cmd+P** on macOS / **Ctrl+P** on Windows. Each opens the main report picker.

Choose a report from the dropdown:

- **Mic plot**
- **Character plot**
- **Actor plot**
- **DCA plot**
- **Backstage swaps**
- **Choose Actors**

Full plot reports

The Mic, Character and Actor plot reports show the corresponding allocation view. DCA plot prints the numbered DCA plan, showing selected characters and the mic numbers resolved from the allocation grid.

Wide plots are split into groups of scenes, with row labels and scene headings repeated for each group.

Use **Scenes per page group** to choose how many scenes appear together:

- **4:** larger cells.
- **6:** standard.
- **8:** more compact.

Choose a smaller group if character names or handovers need more space.

Fit all mic rows on one page

For **Mic plot** only, enable **Fit all mic rows on one page (A4 landscape)** to keep every mic row together. The option is off by default.

Your selected 4, 6 or 8 scenes per page group is retained. Each group scales onto its own A4 landscape page; it does not squeeze the entire show onto one page. This is useful when the last mic would otherwise spill onto another sheet.

Large plots may need smaller text. Check readability and use A4 landscape in the system print dialog. Leave the option off for the normal report layout.

The fitted report retains the StageMic header, legend and yellow swap highlighting. Red conflict highlighting takes priority.

Backstage swaps report

The Backstage swaps report lists handovers in chronological scene order.

It includes the mic, outgoing and incoming wearer or Mic table, and the scene in which the change is placed. A **Notes** column is included only when at least one printed handover has a note. Notes are entered in Backstage swaps on the host or a remote with Completions and swap notes permission. Pre-Show notes are excluded with their collections.

Completion ticks, green progress highlighting and completion counts are excluded. The report shows the planned handovers rather than progress from a particular performance.

Individual actor reports

To produce one page per actor:

1. Select **Choose Actors**.
2. Search for an actor by name.
3. Select the actors you want to include.
4. Select **Print**.

The picker lists actors, rather than characters. Characters must be linked to actors in Production setup to appear on these reports.

Selections remain when you change the search.

Select all and Deselect all

Select all selects every actor, including those hidden by the current search.

When every actor is selected, the button becomes **Deselect all**. This also applies to the whole actor list, not just the currently visible list when using Search.

Actor report layout

Each selected actor receives a separate landscape page containing:

- The production and actor name.
- Their linked characters.
- Scene-by-scene mic allocations.
- Handovers involving their characters.

Long plots use columns and scale to fit the page. Large amounts of information may result in smaller text, so check readability before distributing the report.

Scene wearer lists

Open **Actor plot → Scene wearer list**, choose a scene and use **Print** within that window. This option is not in the main report picker.

The list prints in **portrait**, showing unique wearer names alphabetically without mic numbers. Actor names are used where linked; unlinked characters use their character names. Its scene selection does not change the live display scene. Existing plot and individual-actor reports retain their landscape layouts.

Conflicts and intentional multiple mics

Unresolved multiple-mic allocations are highlighted in reports.

Allocations marked as intentional show their intentional status without a red conflict warning. Both mics remain listed.

Pre-Show and search

Pre-Show and its collection handovers are excluded from every normal printed report, including Backstage swaps and individual actor reports. The collapsed Pre-Show section and its heading are not printed. Search highlighting and available-mic footer counts are also excluded; search does not limit which rows are printed.

Print or save as PDF

After selecting **Print**, use the system print dialog to choose a printer, paper settings and other available options.

To create a PDF, use the operating system’s PDF option, such as **Save as PDF** on macOS or **Microsoft Print to PDF** on Windows.

Available options depend on the operating system and installed printers.

Check before sharing

Review the output before printing multiple copies.

Check that:

- You have selected the intended report and actors.
- Scene names and allocations are current.
- Text is readable.
- The paper size and orientation are appropriate.
- Handovers appear at the intended points in the show.

See Printing Problems if the output does not look as expected.

Printing from a remote

A remote can print the shared show using the same report controls. Printing does not require Edit show permission and does not change the host’s plot. Reports exclude live completion state as usual.

Handover timing and labels

Reports use the handover scenes selected in Mic plot. Timing buttons, “No swap” labels and timing-control columns are excluded.

Mic labels have their own **Export mic labels → Export PDF** action in Mic plot. See Mic Labels.

Offstage styling

Character and Actor plot reports, including individual actor pages, show offstage allocations in grey italics with pale grey shading. Yellow swaps and red conflicts take priority over that shading. The main Mic plot report is unchanged by offstage markings. See Offstage Markings.

Separate collection PDF

The pre-show collection list is **not** an option in the main Print picker. Export it from **Backstage swaps → Pre-Show collections → Export collection list**, then open the PDF to print it. It contains empty paper checkboxes, not live completion state. See Pre-show Collection List.

PRINTING AND SHARING

Export CSV Files

The Mic, Character, Actor and DCA plots can be exported as CSV files.

CSV is useful for opening the allocation table in a spreadsheet or adapting it for other paperwork.

Exporting

1. Open **Mic plot**, **Character plot**, **Actor plot** or **DCA plot**.
2. Select **Export CSV**.
3. Choose a filename and location.
4. Save the file.

The export uses the current show data, including changes that have been autosaved since your last separate `.mic` save.

Opening a CSV

Open the file in a spreadsheet application such as Excel, Numbers or Google Sheets.

If the application asks how to import it, choose:

- **UTF-8** text encoding.
- **Comma** as the separator.
- Double quotes as the text qualifier, where requested.

Cells containing line breaks or punctuation may be quoted in the file. A CSV-aware application interprets those quotes as part of the file structure.

Formatting

CSV contains text and table structure. It does not preserve the app’s colours, fonts, sticky headings or cell styling.

You can format the table after opening it in a spreadsheet.

Completion ticks and live completion highlighting are not included.

CSV and show files

CSV is an export format, not a StageMic show backup.

Editing a CSV does not update the show in StageMic, and CSV files cannot be loaded as `.mic` shows.

Use **Save** to preserve the editable StageMic show.

Copying a table into an email

If you want to paste the plot directly into an email or document, use **Copy table** instead:

1. Open Character plot or Actor plot.
2. Select **Copy table**.
3. Paste into the destination application.

The copied table uses a simplified layout:

- Unassigned allocations are blank.
- Handover text uses “to” or “from”.
- Mic numbers are shown without a “Mic” prefix.
- Actor allocations place the character name on a separate line.

This changes the copied output only. The tables inside StageMic retain their normal appearance.

How much formatting survives depends on the application receiving the paste. You may need to adjust colours, column widths or line breaks there.

Pre-Show and search

Pre-Show and its collections are excluded from CSV exports, copied plot tables and mic-label exports. Search highlights matches in the editor but does not filter the exported or copied data.

Mic plot CSV

Mic plot exports one row per numbered mic and one column per real scene. Cells contain character names or **Mic table**; unassigned cells are blank. This export is the allocation grid, without handover text or Pre-Show. Character and Actor exports continue to include handovers, using any adjusted timing.

Mic labels export as PDF rather than CSV. See Mic Labels.

DCA CSV

DCA export uses numbered DCA rows and real-scene columns. Each cell lists its selected characters and their current mic numbers; characters without an allocation are labelled **No mic**. Offstage DCA entries include an offstage text annotation. DCA export does not control or program a console automatically.

Offstage styling from Actor and Character plots is not preserved in their CSV exports or copied tables. Use printed reports when you need the visual offstage distinction.

PRINTING AND SHARING

Mic Labels

Export printable labels for your mic packs from **Mic plot → Export mic labels**.

1. Choose **Characters** or **Actors**. Characters is the default.
2. Select **Export PDF**.
3. Choose a filename and location.
4. Open the saved PDF to print it.

This is a separate export, not an option in the main Print report picker.

Label layout

The PDF uses A4 portrait pages with two columns of labels. Each label has a border for trimming and centred text: the mic number on its own line, followed by the wearer list.

```
1
Lucy · Tumnus · King Edmund
```

There is no production heading or page header/footer. Longer lists wrap within the label. Check readability before printing; the layout is intended for cutting out labels rather than alignment with a particular pre-cut label sheet.

Names included

Each wearer appears once, in order of first use across the real scenes, with names separated by middle dots.

- **Characters:** lists each character who wears that mic.
- **Actors:** combines characters linked to the same actor into one actor name. Unlinked characters retain their character names.

Unassigned cells and Mic table are excluded. An unused mic still receives a numbered label with no wearer names. Pre-Show collections, notes, completion status and search highlights are not included.

Label export does not change allocations or save the editable show. Use **File → Save…** for a separate `.mic` backup.

PRINTING AND SHARING

Pre-show Collection List

Export a separate paper checklist for collecting mics before each performance.

This is the explicit exception to excluding Pre-Show from paperwork. It does **not** add Pre-Show to plot reports, the Backstage swaps report or individual actor reports.

Export the PDF

1. Open **Backstage swaps**.
2. Expand **Pre-Show collections**.
3. Select **Export collection list**.
4. Enter a whole number from **1 to 100** performances.
5. Select **Export PDF** and choose where to save it.
6. Open the saved PDF to view or print it.

The export is separate from the main File → Print report picker.

What is included

The list uses the automatic Pre-Show collections derived from the **first real scene**.

Each row has:

- The mic number.
- The character collecting it.
- Their linked actor, or a blank actor cell if unlinked.
- One empty paper checkbox per performance.

Each performance column is numbered and has a space to write its date. The report includes the production name and uses A4 portrait pages.

Blank and Mic table allocations in the first scene do not create collection rows. A mic first used in a later scene is not included. If there are no collections, StageMic asks you to allocate characters in the first scene before exporting.

Multiple performances and pages

Up to **six performance columns** appear together. Additional performances start another group of pages with the mic, character and actor information repeated. Long lists can span pages, with table headings repeated.

For example, eight performances produce one group for performances 1–6 and another for 7–8.

Paper checks are independent

All boxes are empty when exported. They are for marking on paper, not interactive PDF form fields.

The PDF does not include current completion ticks or collection notes. Marking paper boxes does not update StageMic, and **Reset all completions** does not change a previously exported PDF.

Review the first-scene allocations and actor links before generating copies. Export again if the collection plan changes.

An approved collaboration remote can export this read-only list without Edit show permission.

See Pre-Show for live collection tracking.

PRINTING AND SHARING

Moving Shows Between Computers

Use a `.mic` file to move a show between computers.

The file carries the allocation plan. Licence activation, network settings and performance completion records are managed separately.

Save on the original computer

1. Open the show in StageMic.
2. Select **Save**.
3. Choose a recognisable filename and location.
4. Transfer that `.mic` file to the other computer.

You can use a USB drive, file share, email attachment or another transfer method.

Autosave remains on the original computer. Save a separate `.mic` file to transfer your latest work.

Open on the receiving computer

1. Install StageMic.
2. Activate a valid licence.
3. Select **Load** and choose the transferred file.
4. Respond to the save-current-show prompt.
5. Check the production name, scene order and allocations.

Where file associations are configured, you can also double-click the `.mic` file.

What moves with the show

The file includes:

- Scenes, characters and actors.
- Character-to-actor links.
- Mics and allocations.

- Mic table assignments.
- Intentional multiple-mic approvals.
- The incomplete-handover alert setting.
- Stable scene identifiers used by individual OSC cues.

What does not move

The following are not included:

- Licence activation.
- Display and OSC interfaces or ports.
- The Crew password.
- Remembered Crew browser logins.
- Handover completion records.

Configure these separately on the receiving computer.

Licence activation

The receiving computer needs an available activation slot on a suitable licence.

If you are retiring the original computer and need to release its slot, deactivate it from the Licence screen while connected to the internet.

Do this after any running performance. Deactivation quits StageMic and stops its displays.

A `.mic` file does not transfer or release a licence activation.

Reconnect backstage displays

Open Settings → Network setup on the receiving computer and check its display interface and port.

Use its generated links or QR codes to connect backstage devices. The computer’s address may differ from the original, so existing bookmarks may need updating.

Set a Crew password on the receiving computer if required.

Check OSC control

Individual scene identifiers remain in the transferred show, so its scene-specific OSC addresses remain the same.

However, your controller may need a new destination address or port for the receiving computer.

If QLab and StageMic run together on the replacement Mac, the default localhost destination can remain appropriate. If they run on separate computers, check the network destination carefully.

Prepare completion tracking

Completion records do not travel with the show.

Before the performance, use **Reset all completions** on the receiving computer to establish a clean starting state, especially if that computer has opened the production before.

Avoid conflicting copies

Separate saved copies are not automatically merged or synchronised. For simultaneous work on the same active show, use Collaboration.

If both copies are edited, decide which is the current version before transferring again. Use descriptive filenames to distinguish revisions.

Before running the show

Check:

- The correct show version is loaded.
- The licence is ready for the intended offline use.
- Allocations and actor links are correct.
- The opening scene can be selected.
- OSC cues reach the new computer.
- Backstage displays connect and follow scene changes.
- Completion tracking is ready for the performance.

Keep a separate backup of the transferred `.mic` file.

Notes and display preferences

Handover notes travel with the `.mic` show file, including Pre-Show collection notes. Display size and Hide completed preferences are stored in each display browser and do not travel with the show.

Save a copy from a remote

While connected, **Save a Copy** writes the shared show to a local `.mic` file. To use that copy independently, disconnect and confirm returning to your local show, then Load the saved copy.

This does not transfer the live host role, completion records, Crew password or network configuration. There is no automatic host takeover if the original host disconnects.

Troubleshooting and Support

Display Connection Problems

Backstage displays need a working local network connection to the computer running StageMic.

Internet access alone does not confirm that the devices can communicate.

The display will not open

Check StageMic

Confirm that:

- StageMic is open on the controlling computer.
- A valid session has started.
- Network setup shows the display server running.

If StageMic is waiting for licence activation or a required check-in, complete that before connecting displays.

Check the link

Use a link shown in **Network setup → Backstage displays**.

Check that the address and port match the current settings. If the computer has changed networks or received a new IP address, an old bookmark may no longer work.

Do not use `0.0.0.0` as the browser destination. It is a listening setting, not the controlling computer’s address.

Check the network

Confirm that the controlling computer and display device can communicate.

Guest Wi-Fi, client isolation and separate network segments can block connections. Two devices having internet access—or showing the same Wi-Fi name—does not guarantee communication between them.

Ask the venue’s network administrator if you are unsure.

Check the firewall

Allow StageMic’s incoming connections if the controlling computer’s firewall asks.

The default display service uses TCP port `8910`. If you changed the port, use that configured value instead.

Several display addresses are shown

A computer connected through Ethernet, Wi-Fi or other interfaces may have several addresses.

Use the one reachable from your display device.

Selecting a specific display interface in Network setup can make the intended connection clearer.

It opens on the computer but not on another device

The **Open** button confirms that the computer can reach its own display service. It does not prove that another device can reach it across the network.

Check the selected interface, device network, firewall and any client-isolation restrictions.

The Crew password is rejected

Check the password and letter case.

If necessary, use **Change crew password** on the controlling computer to set a replacement. Existing Crew logins will be signed out.

Passwords belong to the controlling computer. Loading a show file does not restore a Crew password from another computer.

A Crew display asks for its password again

This can happen after:

- Changing the Crew password.
- Clearing browser cookies.
- Using private browsing.
- A remembered login expires.

Log in again using the current password.

The display shows disconnected

Check that StageMic is still open and the controlling computer is awake.

Browsers can suspend background tabs, and display devices may stop receiving updates while locked or asleep. Bring the display to the foreground and check whether it reconnects.

StageMic sends connection heartbeats approximately every five seconds. The display treats a prolonged silence of roughly twelve seconds as a lost connection, although browser suspension can affect when that status appears.

Completion controls are disabled while disconnected.

The scene or allocations look wrong

First check the connection banner. A disconnected display may still show its last received information.

Then confirm the selected scene on the controlling computer.

Current allocations shows the plot for that scene. It does not track the physical location of packs.

Before relying on the connection

After resolving a problem:

1. Select a scene on the controlling computer.
2. Confirm that every display follows.

3. Test a completion update if you use completion tracking.
4. Restore the intended opening scene and reset test completions.

If the problem continues, see Reporting a Bug.

Understanding the timestamp

Updated means the display received a show snapshot. This can happen after a scene change or a handover completion update. It does not mean that the scene necessarily changed. Heartbeat messages may instead show **Connection checked**.

Checking connected tabs

Use **Settings → Network setup → Connected displays** on the controlling computer to see active display connections. Each tab has its own row; several rows with the same address can be normal. Close duplicate tabs if they are no longer needed.

Completed handovers seem to be missing

Check the display's **Hide completed** switch. Turn it off to reveal completed cards. The progress count includes hidden completions. This setting does not delete handovers or reset their status.

Display size or preferences changed

Choose Compact, Standard or Large using **Display size** at the top right. Preferences are stored in that browser. A different browser, cleared storage, private browsing, or a changed server address or port can start with default preferences again. See Display Settings.

Displays during collaboration

Connect browser displays to the host’s display link, normally on port 8910. A remote stops its own display server while connected to the host. The collaboration address on port 8911 is for connecting another StageMic desktop app, not opening a backstage display.

TROUBLESHOOTING AND SUPPORT

OSC Problems

If OSC does not change StageMic’s current scene, check the destination, transport and message separately.

Confirm manual control works

Select a scene manually in StageMic.

If the editor and backstage displays respond correctly, focus on the OSC connection or controller configuration.

Check the destination

The default OSC receiver is:

Setting	Default
Interface	Localhost (`127.0.0.1`)
UDP port	`9000`

Localhost works only when the sender and StageMic run on the same computer.

For a controller on another computer:

1. Select a reachable interface or All interfaces in StageMic.
2. Apply the network settings.
3. Set the controller’s destination to the StageMic computer’s reachable address.
4. Match the configured OSC port.

Do not send OSC to the display server’s browser port.

Check the transport

StageMic receives properly encoded **OSC over UDP**.

It does not interpret plain text sent to the UDP port as OSC. A TCP connection is also unsuitable.

In QLab, use an OSC message patch with UDP transport.

Test a simple message

Send:

```
/stagemic/scene/go/next
```

Use no arguments.

If no scene is selected, this selects the first scene. At the final scene, it cannot advance further, so select an earlier scene before testing again.

A specific scene cue does not work

Select the intended scene manually and copy its reference message from Network setup again.

Check that:

- The cue uses the correct show’s scene identifier.
- The scene has not been deleted and recreated.
- The message contains no accidental spaces or altered characters.
- The controller sends to the correct computer and port.

Renaming or reordering an existing scene preserves its identifier. Recreating it does not.

A numeric scene message fails

Send the scene position as an OSC integer argument.

For example:

```
/stagemic/scene 3
```

This selects the third scene in production order.

The string `"3"` is treated as an identifier, rather than a scene position. Scene names are not accepted as substitutes for identifiers.

StageMic advances twice

Check for:

- Duplicate Network cues.
- Repeated button presses or triggers.
- The same message sent through multiple patch destinations.
- A manual advance followed by an automatic one.

Each next-scene message advances once. StageMic does not merge repeated advances into a single action.

Use a specific scene cue to restore the intended position.

Cues select the wrong scene after editing

Numeric cues select by position. Inserting, splitting, removing or reordering scenes can change their meaning. Splitting retains the original stable address on Part 1; Part 2 receives a new address.

Use stable scene-specific addresses for reference cues, and review positional cues after changing scene order.

Check the network and firewall

For OSC from another computer, confirm that the devices can communicate and that the firewall permits incoming UDP traffic on StageMic's configured OSC port.

OSC has no authentication. Use a trusted show network.

Check network status

Review the OSC activity and error information in Network setup.

StageMic does not send an OSC acknowledgement back to the controller, so confirm the result using its current-scene selector or a connected display.

See OSC Dictionary for supported messages.

Selecting Pre-Show

Send `/stagemic/scene/preshow` without arguments. Pre-Show is not scene number `0`; integer `1` selects the first real scene. Next from the waiting state skips Pre-Show, so select it explicitly when you need initial collections.

OSC during collaboration

Only the host receives OSC for the shared show. Remotes pause their own OSC receivers while connected. If QLab is on another computer, `127.0.0.1` will not reach the host: use the host's network address and configure its OSC interface in Settings → Network setup.

Scene control permission on a remote does not change the OSC receiver's network access. OSC remains unauthenticated.

TROUBLESHOOTING AND SUPPORT

Licence and Activation Problems

Licence activation and check-ins require a working internet connection.

The Licence screen shows the saved activation status and any error from the latest request.

Activation fails

Check that:

- The licence key was copied completely.
- The computer has internet access.
- The licence has not expired or been suspended.
- An activation slot is available.

A network that allows local backstage displays may still block access to the internet or licensing service.

Keep the full error message if you need support.

Activation limit reached

Each activated computer uses a machine slot.

Deactivate an old computer from inside StageMic if it is still available. If it is lost or no longer works, contact StageMic support to request release of that activation.

Deleting local licence files does not release the slot. Windows uninstall can attempt deactivation if its optional checkbox is selected; verify success before assuming the slot is free.

A check-in is due

Connect to the internet, open **Licence** and select **Check in now**.

Use the deadline displayed by StageMic when planning offline use. Its time of day may differ from the time you last activated or checked in.

A Standard licence with no overall expiry can still require recurring check-ins.

An online request fails, but offline access remains valid

Connection failures and temporary service outages allow fallback to a valid saved paid offline allowance. Read the status and displayed deadline.

A confirmed rejection, such as an expired or suspended licence, blocks a new session even if a previous certificate had time remaining. The rejection is remembered; going offline does not bypass it. Resolve the licence status and validate online again.

Resolve the connection problem and check in before that deadline.

A trial will not start offline

Trials require online validation at the start of each new session.

A saved activation or an earlier daily check-in does not allow a new trial session to start offline.

Reconnect and select **Continue to show** again.

A trial has expired

Activate a paid licence to start further sessions.

Your locally stored show data remains available; switching to a paid licence does not require recreating the plot.

Removing the trial or reinstalling StageMic does not restart the evaluation period.

The computer clock is incorrect

An incorrect date or time can prevent certificate validation.

Check the operating system’s date, time and time-zone settings, then retry the licensing action. Enable automatic time synchronisation where appropriate.

Deactivation fails

Deactivation needs to contact the licensing service.

Check the connection and retry. If deactivation fails, do not assume that the machine slot has been released.

Contact support if you cannot complete it.

Uninstalling did not release the activation

The Windows uninstaller attempts deactivation only when its optional checkbox is selected. Updates and silent uninstalls skip deactivation. If it fails and you choose Ignore, the activation may remain registered. macOS removal has no automatic deactivation step.

Deactivate inside StageMic before uninstalling if you want to release a paid licence slot. If the app has already been removed, reinstall it and try deactivation, or contact support.

A deadline passes during a show

A session that started with a valid licence continues running if its deadline passes.

Complete the required check-in before closing and reopening StageMic. Deactivation is an explicit action that quits the app, so do not use it during a performance.

Getting help

Include the StageMic version, operating system, action attempted and exact error message.

Do not post your licence key publicly. Only provide it through a private support route if requested.

Windows cannot read Machine ID

If the error mentions `reg.exe`, `MachineGuid` or registry editing being disabled, Windows policy is blocking the machine-identity query used for licensing. This is different from a port conflict.

Ask the computer administrator to allow the necessary query for the account running StageMic. A policy targeting non-administrators can still apply even if another account works. Do not edit or delete the MachineGuid value to work around the error.

Activation files are stored separately for each operating-system user account. If an unexpected slot is in use, contact support rather than deleting activation files.

Collaboration licensing

Every remote requires its own valid StageMic session before connecting. The host does not lend its activation to remotes. Browser-based backstage displays still require no separate licence.

StageMic has returned to key entry

If a launch check confirms that this computer’s machine record or its licence was deleted, StageMic clears its saved activation and returns to the unactivated screen. This is the expected result of remote deactivation; the app does not recreate the activation automatically. Enter a valid licence key and activate explicitly if authorised, or contact support if the removal was unexpected. Your show files are not deleted.

The licence was deleted in Keygen

StageMic checks for confirmed deletion when an online activation check encounters a rejected licence. Once confirmed, it clears the local activation and returns to key entry. Deactivate also succeeds when the licence or machine record is already gone.

An unrelated authentication error, unreadable response or service outage does not by itself confirm deletion. If the problem persists, keep the exact error and contact support. Discovery during a manual check does not interrupt an already-running show; a new session needs a valid activation.

TROUBLESHOOTING AND SUPPORT

Show Files and Autosave Recovery

StageMic restores its locally autosaved show when it opens.

Separate `.mic` files provide backups and allow you to move between saved versions.

The wrong show opens

StageMic restores the current autosave, which may differ from the last separate file you saved.

Use **Load** to open the intended `.mic` file.

If you want to keep the currently restored work, save it under a different filename before replacing it.

A saved file is missing recent changes

Autosave does not continuously update your separately saved `.mic` file.

If StageMic still has the newer show open, select **Save** to write an updated copy.

If you are about to investigate recovery, first save any currently open work you want to keep under a new filename.

Startup recovery

If the autosave cannot be loaded safely, StageMic preserves a recovery copy in the same folder, named `autosave.mic.recovery-<timestamp>`. The recovery dialog shows its location.

For an autosave containing more than 50 mics, choose whether to recover the first 50 mics, start a blank show or quit. Recovering the first 50 removes higher-numbered mic rows and their associated notes from the working copy; the original recovery file remains available. Inspect the recovered show and save a separate copy before continuing.

For other unreadable autosaves, you can start a blank show or quit and investigate the preserved file. Files larger than 16 MB are rejected before parsing. This recovery process does not replace keeping your own backups.

If you have problems with `.mic` files being rejected, contact us, providing the .mic file and we may be able to repair it.

Locate autosave

The default autosave location is:

macOS

```
~/Library/Application Support/stagemic-desktop/autosave.mic
```

In Finder, choose **Go → Go to Folder** and enter:

```
~/Library/Application Support/stagemic-desktop/
```

Windows

```
%APPDATA%\stagemic-desktop\autosave.mic
```

Enter `%APPDATA%\stagemic-desktop\` in File Explorer's address bar to open the folder.

These are application-data locations, rather than the folder containing the app.

Preserve a possible recovery copy

If you find an autosave you want to investigate:

1. Quit StageMic.
2. Copy `autosave.mic` to another folder.
3. Give the copy a recognisable filename.
4. Keep the original untouched.
5. Reopen StageMic and use **Load** to open the copy.

If a file may contain recoverable work and StageMic is currently closed, copy it before launching the app.

Autosave is not version history

Autosave records edits, including deletions and replacements.

Creating a new show or loading another one changes the current autosaved show. Autosave does not retain every previous production or plotting revision.

Look for separate `.mic` backups or copies in your own backup system if the desired work is no longer in autosave.

StageMic rejects a file

Check that you selected a StageMic `.mic` file.

CSV exports, PDFs and copied tables cannot be loaded as shows.

If a file has been edited manually or damaged during transfer, preserve the original and try another saved copy. Avoid repeatedly editing the only copy.

Include the error message when contacting support.

The file opens in a text editor

This is usually an operating-system file association.

You can open the file using **Load** inside StageMic regardless of its current association.

To change the default application:

- **macOS:** use **Get Info → Open with → StageMic → Change All**.
- **Windows:** use **Open with** and choose StageMic as the default.

After recovery

Check the production name, scene order, allocations and actor links.

Save the recovered show as a separate `.mic` file before continuing work.

Do not send the entire application-data folder with a bug report. It contains machine-specific settings and may include licence or Crew authentication data. Send only the relevant show file if requested.

Undo history

Show-edit undo history is temporary and separate from autosave or saved `.mic` files. It holds up to 100 editing steps per editor, subject to a shared memory limit that may discard older steps sooner. It resets when you create or load a show, and is not restored after a restart. Undo and redo results are autosaved. Use saved backups for longer-term recovery. See Undo and Redo.

Shared-show recovery

During collaboration, the host autosaves the shared show. A remote's local autosave remains its pre-connection show; it is not a backup of remote edits. Use Save a Copy while connected if you need a separate shared-show backup on that computer.

There is no automatic host takeover after a failure. Recover the host's autosave or load a previously saved copy on another computer, then configure its displays and OSC as needed.

TROUBLESHOOTING AND SUPPORT

Printing Problems

StageMic prints through a dedicated report layout and the operating system's print dialog.

Start by checking the report selection and preview.

The wrong report appears

Open **Print** and confirm the selected report.

For individual actor pages, choose **Choose Actors** rather than **Actor plot**.

The Actor plot report includes the full plot. Choose Actors creates a separate page for each selected actor.

An actor is missing from the picker

The picker lists entries from the Actors list in Production setup.

Check that:

- The person has been added as an actor.
- Their name is not hidden by the current search.
- Their characters are linked to them.

Unlinked characters appear separately in the Actor plot but are not selectable as actors.

More actors print than expected

Selections remain when you change the search.

Select all includes every actor, including those hidden by the current search. **Deselect all** clears the whole list.

Review the selected count before printing.

Text is too small

For full plot reports, choose fewer **Scenes per page group** to give each scene more space.

Individual actor reports fit one actor onto one landscape A4 page. Long plots or extensive handover information can produce smaller text.

Check the preview and paper settings before printing multiple copies.

Content is clipped or scaled unexpectedly

Check the system print dialog’s:

- Paper size.
- Orientation.
- Scaling.
- Pages-per-sheet setting.
- Printer-specific margins or layout options.

Try landscape orientation for plot reports.

If necessary, save a PDF first and inspect it to determine whether the issue is in the report or the printer settings.

Colours are missing

Check whether the printer or print dialog is set to grayscale, black and white or an economy mode.

Unresolved conflicts and intentional double-mic labels should still be reviewed in StageMic before printing. Do not rely only on colour to check the plot.

Completion ticks are missing

This is expected.

Printed reports exclude live completion ticks, green completion highlighting and completion counts. They show the allocation and handover plan rather than progress from a particular performance.

Pre-Show collections are missing

This is intentional. Pre-Show collections appear on live displays and in the computer’s collapsed Backstage swaps section, but not in normal printed reports. Export the separate collection PDF from **Backstage swaps → Pre-Show collections → Export collection list** when you need a paper checklist.

Printing a scene wearer list

Use **Actor plot → Scene wearer list → Print**, rather than the main Print modal. Wearer lists use portrait pages; plots and individual actor reports retain their landscape layouts. Check the system print dialog if a saved printer preference overrides the orientation.

Saving a PDF

Use the system print dialog’s PDF option.

On macOS this is normally available through the PDF menu. On Windows, an installed PDF printer such as Microsoft Print to PDF can be selected.

PDF options depend on the operating system and available printers.

Reporting a layout problem

Include:

- StageMic version and operating system.
- Report type.
- Paper size and orientation.
- Scenes per page group, where applicable.
- Whether the issue also appears in a saved PDF.
- A screenshot or sample PDF showing the problem.

Remove private cast or production information where necessary.

See Reporting a Bug.

The Notes column is missing

The Backstage swaps report shows a Notes column only if at least one handover included in that report has a note. If you added notes only to Pre-Show collections, the column remains absent: Pre-Show is excluded from that report. The separate collection PDF does not include notes either. Notes are not added to plot or individual actor reports.

A mic row spills onto a second page

Choose **File → Print… → Mic plot** and enable **Fit all mic rows on one page (A4 landscape)**. Each selected scene group scales to one page containing all mic rows. Use A4 landscape and check the resulting text size. This option does not apply to other report types.

Printing mic labels

Mic labels now export directly as PDF from **Mic plot → Export mic labels**. Open the PDF to print it. Labels have two columns with borders for trimming and no page header; they are not a template for a particular adhesive-label sheet.

Collection-list performance columns

The separate pre-show collection PDF groups up to six performances together. More performances produce additional groups of pages, repeating the mic, character and actor columns. All checkboxes start empty, regardless of live completion state. If there are no collections, check the first real scene: blank and Mic table allocations do not create collection rows.

TROUBLESHOOTING AND SUPPORT

Reporting a Bug

Use the bug-reporting portal linked from the StageMic website to report unexpected behaviour.

A useful report explains what happened, what you expected and how to reproduce it.

During a performance

Prioritise the running show.

Use manual scene selection or an established fallback where appropriate. Avoid restarting, updating or changing network settings during a performance solely to investigate a bug.

Record the details when practical and submit the report afterwards.

Before reporting

Check the relevant troubleshooting page and the release notes.

If you can reproduce the issue safely, note the shortest sequence of steps that causes it.

Do not risk your only show copy while testing. Save a separate `.mic` backup before making experimental changes.

What to include

Provide:

- **StageMic version.**
- **Operating system and version.**
- **What you were trying to do.**
- **Steps to reproduce the issue.**
- **What you expected.**
- **What actually happened.**

- **Any exact error message.**
- **Whether it happens consistently or intermittently.**

For display problems, also include the device, browser and connection method.

For OSC problems, include the controller, destination settings and message sent.

We suggest using the File → Copy diagnostics menu item.

Suggested report format

Summary
A short description of the problem.

Environment
StageMic version, operating system and any relevant display or controller details.

Steps to reproduce
A numbered sequence someone else can follow.

Expected result
What should have happened.

Actual result
What happened instead.

Attachments
Relevant screenshots, recordings or a minimal example show.

Attachments

Screenshots and short recordings can make interface problems easier to understand.

For plotting issues, a small `.mic` file that reproduces the problem is often more useful than a large production file.

If possible, replace real cast names with fictional names before sharing.

Do not attach licence keys, Crew passwords, browser authentication cookies or the entire StageMic application-data folder.

Check whether the portal entry and attachments will be public before submitting them.

Follow-up information

Support may ask for a smaller example, another screenshot or a test on a later version.

Keep a copy of the affected show so that the issue can be investigated without altering your working production file.

Copy diagnostics

File → Copy diagnostics will copy a report to your clipboard as follows:

> StageMic version: v1.11.0 > > Platform: macOS 26.7.1 (Darwin 25.6.0) > > Architecture: arm64 > > Licence type: Standard > > Licence status: Activated > > Session active: Yes > > Machine ID: 00000a00-0000-000a-0000-0a0000a0aaa0 > > Offline deadline: Not applicable > > Trial expiry: Not

applicable > > Display server: Running > > Display interface: All interfaces (0.0.0.0) > > Display port: 8910 > > Connected displays: 0 > > Crew password configured: Yes > > OSC interface: Localhost (127.0.0.1) > > OSC port: 9000 > > Last OSC received: None > > Last OSC error: None > > Generated: [Timestamp]

Collaboration reports

Include the versions and operating systems of both host and remote, which computer performed the action, the remote's permissions, and whether the connection was active or reconnecting. Say whether the issue affected the host, other remotes or browser displays.

For a conflicting edit, describe what each person changed and in what order. Do not include licence keys, Crew passwords or private show data in a public report.

TROUBLESHOOTING AND SUPPORT

Requesting a Feature

Use the feature-request portal linked from the StageMic website to suggest improvements.

The most useful requests describe a real workflow and the problem you want to solve.

Check existing requests

Look for an existing request before creating a new one.

If someone has already described the same need, add your use case or support that request through the portal.

Explain the problem

Describe:

- What you are trying to achieve.
- How you currently do it.
- What makes the current process difficult.
- How often the situation occurs.
- Who would benefit from an improvement.

A practical example from a rehearsal or performance helps explain why the feature matters.

Suggest an approach

You can suggest a button, setting or workflow, but include the underlying need too.

For example, "I need crew to distinguish a returned pack from one still with an actor" gives useful context beyond a particular interface proposal.

Mention any effects the change might have on backstage displays, printing, OSC or existing show files.

Keep requests focused

Use one request per distinct feature where practical.

Related details can stay together, but separate unrelated ideas so that each can be discussed and tracked independently.

Examples and privacy

Screenshots, sketches and small fictional examples are welcome.

Avoid publishing licence keys, Crew passwords or private production and cast information.

Requests and release plans

Submitting a request does not guarantee that it will be implemented or included in a particular release.

Features are considered alongside practical theatre use, reliability, complexity and compatibility with existing workflows.

Bug or feature request?

Report something as a **bug** when an existing feature behaves incorrectly.

Submit a **feature request** when you want StageMic to support a new task or a different way of working.

If you are unsure, explain the situation clearly and it can be categorised during review.

TROUBLESHOOTING AND SUPPORT

Collaboration Problems

The show is not discovered

Check that the host has enabled Collaboration and both computers use the same StageMic version. They must be on a network that permits device-to-device communication.

Automatic discovery uses UDP 49141 multicast. Guest Wi-Fi, client isolation or managed networks can block it. Try the host address from Settings → Collaboration, including port 8911.

If direct connection works, discovery is the part being blocked. If neither works, check reachability and firewall access to TCP 8911.

Connection is refused or times out

Confirm that StageMic is still open on the host and Enable Collaboration is on. Use a reachable host address, not `0.0.0.0` or localhost from another computer.

Collaboration uses TCP 8911. The browser-display port 8910 and OSC port 9000 are different services. Changing the display port does not change the collaboration port.

If another application uses 8911, resolve that conflict before enabling collaboration. v1.14 has no collaboration port picker.

The request stays pending

The host must accept the request. Check its approval dialog. Requests expire after about a minute; send a fresh request if necessary.

Removing a remote revokes that session. It cannot reconnect using its previous approval.

Controls are missing or disabled

Check the switches for that remote on the host. Edit show, Completions and swap notes, and Scene control are independent. A remote without Scene control does not see the scene selector or Next button.

All shared editing and live actions are disabled when disconnected. A valid local licence session is also required.

An edit was rejected

Another editor may have changed the same information, or a structural edit may have changed the scene or character layout. Review the host’s current show, then reapply the intended change if still appropriate.

Undo can also be rejected when it would overwrite a later change. Do not repeatedly retry without checking the current result.

The connection drops

Keep the host awake and connected. Brief interruptions can reconnect automatically; longer interruptions can expire the session and require a new connection request. Removal by the host also requires fresh approval.

The host remains authoritative. There is no offline editing queue or automatic host takeover. Check the resulting state after reconnection before repeating an uncertain completion or scene action.

OSC or browser displays stopped on the remote

This is expected while connected. The host serves the shared show’s displays and receives OSC. Use its links and destination address.

After Disconnect, the remote returns to its local show and restarts its own services. Check that computer’s network configuration and scene selection before using them.

Collecting a useful report

Record both computers’ StageMic versions, operating systems, permissions and the exact error. Explain whether manual connection worked when discovery did not. Use File → Copy diagnostics on each computer if helpful, and review the reports before sharing.

See Reporting a Bug.

Versions do not match

Use v1.18 on both the host and every remote. Older versions may not support the same show features; v1.14 and earlier also use an incompatible collaboration protocol.

An update seems delayed

Remotes check for updates frequently, but a change is not instantaneous. StageMic also defers show redraws while you are using an input, allocation selector or dialog. Finish the edit, move focus away or close the dialog to display queued changes. This helps protect your current selection and scroll position.

Memory use rises while editing

Processing and displaying changes can temporarily increase memory use. A peak that falls again does not by itself establish a memory leak. If memory keeps rising during repeated work or the app becomes unresponsive, report the host and remote versions, show size, number of connected remotes, which computer is affected and the actions that trigger it. Include Copy diagnostics, and record memory readings separately if available.

Release notes

Release notes describe the changes introduced in each StageMic version.

This documentation covers v1.18.

v1.18

Offstage and DCA planning

- Mark allocated Character/Actor plot cells offstage while retaining the mic. Markings stay in sync between views, save with the show and support undo/redo.
- Show offstage allocations in dark blue italics in the app and grey italics with pale grey shading in relevant printed reports. Mic plot and handover timing are unchanged.
- Add numbered DCA plans for each real scene, with 1–32 DCAs and no fill-forward.
- Search character cards grouped by onstage/offstage/unmic’d status, sorted by mic number within mic’d groups.
- Dim onstage characters already assigned to a DCA in the scene while keeping them selectable.
- Print DCA plans or export them as CSV. These are programming references, not console-control commands.

Navigation and history

- Remember separate horizontal and vertical scroll positions for Mic, Character, Actor and DCA plots within the current window.
- Navigate cells with arrow keys. A keyboard allocation list confirms with Enter or cancels with Escape, returning focus directly to the cell.
- Open character mic history from a character's name in Character plot, including allocation ranges and relevant handovers.

Pre-show paperwork

- Export a separate collection PDF from Backstage swaps → Pre-Show collections.
- Choose 1–100 performances, with date spaces and empty paper checkboxes. Groups of up to six performance columns repeat mic, character and actor information.
- Keep Pre-Show excluded from normal reports. Paper checks are independent of live completion tracking.

Collaboration and licensing

- Connection requests ask for Windows taskbar or macOS Dock attention without showing, restoring or focusing the host window.
- Confirmed deleted licences clear local activation during launch checks. Deactivation also succeeds if the licence or machine record is already deleted.
- Connection failures and unrelated authentication errors do not erase saved activation. A running show remains active if deletion is discovered during a manual check.

Use v1.18 on the host and every remote to support the same show features. See Installing and Updating.

v1.17

Interface and workflow

- Moved show commands and Licence into File, and Search into Edit, leaving a simpler header. Keyboard shortcuts remain available.
- Made Mic plot, Character plot, Actor plot and Backstage swaps consistent tabs, with squared panel tops.
- Removed the duplicate macOS fullscreen menu item.
- Hidden licence-key entry when a licence is already installed.
- Added a bundled offline licence agreement, with acceptance remembered for the current computer user.
- Reduced unnecessary allocation-dropdown and collaboration refresh work.
- Removed START-HERE.txt from Windows portable archives.

Handover timing

- Added **Move to next scene** beneath eligible Mic plot handovers, moving the change through consecutive unassigned scenes before the receiving allocation.
- Added **Reset timing** to restore automatic placement.
- Timing choices are saved with the show, shared with collaborators and included in undo/redo. Editing timing requires Edit show permission.
- Displays, alerts and reports follow the chosen timing. Moving a completed handover requires it to be marked complete again.
- Pre-Show remains unchanged. Timing controls and “No swap” labels never appear in printed reports.

Printing and sharing

- Added Mic plot CSV export, with mic rows and real-scene columns.
- Added optional **Fit all mic rows on one page (A4 landscape)** for Mic plot reports. Each chosen scene group scales onto one page while retaining the StageMic header, legend and yellow swap highlighting.
- Replaced mic-label CSV export with PDF: two columns of bordered, centred labels with the mic number above the wearer list and no page header.
- Labels default to Characters, also support Actors, and list each wearer once in first-use order.

Licensing

- Standard licences now validate at online session start while retaining their monthly offline allowance.
- Temporary connection failures can use a valid saved offline allowance. A confirmed rejection blocks a new session and is remembered.
- Remotely removed machine activations return to the normal unactivated screen without a raw machine-not-found error or automatic reactivation.

- Trial validation requirements remain unchanged. Running show sessions remain uninterrupted.

Update the host and remotes together before collaborating. See Installing and Updating.

v1.15

- Move a whole mic’s allocations from Production setup, carrying matching handover notes and clearing affected completion records.
- Mark individual handovers complete directly from incomplete-handover warnings.
- Limit shows to 50 mics, identify occupied mics before reducing the count, and provide safer recovery for invalid or oversized autosaves.
- Reduce repeated collaboration processing through incremental updates and bounded undo history.
- Preserve editing focus and scroll position while receiving changes, with subtle highlights for incoming allocation changes.
- Notify the host when a remote deliberately disconnects.
- Show an opening indicator for Settings and offer Save, Discard or Cancel for unapplied network settings when closing.
- Make returning from the Licence screen clearer with Back to show and Continue to show controls.

Collaboration compatibility: update the host and every remote to v1.15. Older collaboration versions cannot connect to this release.

v1.14

Collaboration

- Connect other licensed StageMic computers to a shared show over the local network.
- Discover hosts automatically or connect by address; the host approves every remote.
- Independent permissions for editing, completions and swap notes, and scene control. View is always enabled.
- Purple remote header, computer-name tab indicators and per-device search.
- Host autosave, remote Save a Copy, per-editor undo/redo and protection against conflicting edits.
- Editing and live actions are disabled during connection loss. Brief interruptions reconnect automatically.
- Disconnect confirmation returns a remote to its own local show.

Settings and show control

- Production setup, Network setup and Collaboration are now in a separate Settings window, opened with Cmd/Ctrl+,.
- Added `/stagemic/completions/reset` without arguments to reset the whole show, including Pre-Show.
- Windows Machine ID access failures now explain the registry-policy issue rather than suggesting a network-port problem.

v1.13.2

These notes cover the v1.13 features and the v1.13.1–v1.13.2 layout refinements.

Backstage displays

- Compact, Standard and Large display sizes, remembered in each display browser.
- Completion progress on every scene, with a Hide completed switch to focus on outstanding handovers.
- Names shrink uniformly and wrap between words without individual text scrollbars.
- Completion buttons prevent text selection and long-press callouts when using hold-to-undo on iPhone Safari.
- Show/display information and display controls share a two-column header beneath the connection banner.

Notes and planning

- Add/Edit note on individual handovers and Pre-Show collections in Backstage swaps, editable only on the controlling computer.
- Notes appear on both display types. Printed swaps include a Notes column only when needed; Pre-Show notes never print.
- Mic history from the information button beside each mic number, grouping matching wearers across unassigned gaps and retaining actual handover timing.
- Connected displays table in Network setup, showing each connection's role, browser/platform and address.

Update checks

- Quiet checks for newer stable releases at launch and **File → Check for Updates** for manual checks.
- A dismissible update banner links to stagemic.co.uk/get.
- No automatic installation or show interruption. Update checks contact GitHub without sending show or licence data; see Privacy.

v1.12.1

Pre-Show collections

- Built-in Pre-Show collections for characters wearing mics in the first real scene.
- Manual selection or `/stagemic/scene/preshow`, without arguments; Next advances into the first real scene.
- Completion tracking on both displays, with completed Pre-Show cards moved below outstanding collections.
- A collapsed Pre-Show collections section in Backstage swaps for operator corrections; Reset all completions includes it.
- Pre-Show is never selected automatically and never appears in plots, printed reports or exports. Numeric scene positions are unchanged.

Plotting and editing

- Split scenes into Part 1 and Part 2 with identical starting allocations.
- Drag scenes, characters and actors to reorder them, alongside the existing arrows.

- Actor/character search from the header or Cmd/Ctrl+F across plots and Backstage swaps.
- Show-edit undo/redo from the Edit menu and platform shortcuts.
- Available-mic counts for explicit Mic table assignments, with tooltips listing mic numbers.

Lists, printing and display wording

- Scene wearer lists in Actor plot, with independent scene selection, alphabetical unique names and a separate portrait Print action.
- Cmd/Ctrl+P and File → Print open the main report picker.
- Improved search spacing and alignment.
- Display snapshot timestamps say Updated rather than Scene updated.

These notes include the v1.12 features and v1.12.1 refinements; v1.12 was not released separately.

v1.11

- Automatic retries while Keygen prepares a new trial expiry, with progress feedback.
- Machine ID in the Licence window and File → Copy diagnostics.
- New, Load, Save and Licence keyboard shortcuts; Space advances when no interactive control is focused and no editor dialog is open.
- CSV mic-label export from Mic plot, using characters or actors.
- Optional Windows uninstall deactivation, with failure choices and safeguards for updates and silent uninstalls.

v1.10

Intentional multiple mics

Multiple-mic allocations can now be marked as intentional.

- Approve an allocation in one scene.
- Apply approval to all currently matching scenes.
- Use **Review assignment** to restore a conflict warning.
- Save approvals with the show and autosave.
- Keep both mics and their independent handovers visible.

Approved allocations use an intentional double-mic label instead of red conflict highlighting. Printed plots and individual actor reports also recognise the approval.

Changes to the wearer, mic combination or character allocation require review again. Renaming or reordering scenes preserves approvals attached to those scenes.

Windows installer

A Windows setup executable is now available alongside portable ZIP packaging.

The installer creates application shortcuts, provides an uninstaller and registers `.mic` files with StageMic. Existing autosave, settings and activation storage are retained.

Uninstalling does not automatically deactivate a licence. Deactivate from inside StageMic first if you want to release the computer’s activation slot.

v1.9

Trial licences

Added support for seven-day trial licences.

Trials require online validation at the start of each new session and daily check-in. Once started, a session continues through connection loss or trial expiry.

Trial expiry is displayed in the app. Trial records are retained to support repeat-trial restrictions.

v1.8.2

Network setup improvements

- Moved QR codes into a modal opened beside each display link.
- Moved the Crew password button and status beneath the Crew link.
- Simplified the confirmation shown when opening another show.

v1.8.1

Network setup layout

- Grouped OSC settings with OSC messages.
- Grouped display settings with backstage display links.
- Renamed **QLab Control** to **OSC Control**.
- Removed localhost from the display interface selector while retaining it for OSC.

v1.8

Stable display links and Crew login

- Added stable `/display` and `/crew` routes.
- Added a themed Crew password screen.
- Added remembered Crew logins.
- Changing the Crew password signs out existing Crew sessions.

Display links remain the same while the computer’s address and display port remain unchanged.

Network interfaces

Added separate interface and port selection for backstage displays and OSC.

Show files and interface

- Added macOS `.mic` file registration.
- Added save-before-replace prompts for loading shows and creating new shows.
- Moved **New** beside **Save** and **Load**.
- Updated the header to **Licence | New Save Load Print**.
- Adjusted dropdown arrow spacing.

v1.7

Incomplete-handover alerts

Added optional silent computer notifications and an in-app warning when moving forward exactly one scene with handovers still unticked in the scene being left.

The setting is off by default and saved with the show. Scene control continues immediately.

Other improvements

- **Select all** changes to **Deselect all** when every actor is selected for printing.
- Improved alignment of display Open buttons.

v1.6

Printing and display previews

- Added **Select all** to the actor report picker.
- Changed individual actor reports to open the system print dialog.
- Added Open buttons for backstage displays.
- Simplified helper text and improved Network setup spacing.

v1.5.1

Complete-only displays

Updated the second display type to allow marking handovers completed without allowing completion to be undone.

Crew displays and computer controls retain their correction options.

v1.5

Shared handover completion

- Added completion controls on backstage displays.
- Shared completion status across connected devices and the control app.
- Added individual corrections in Backstage swaps.
- Added **Reset all completions** for the next performance.
- Added green completion highlighting.

Completion progress is stored separately from show files and excluded from printed reports.

v1.4

Individual actor reports

Added actor selection for reports, with one page per selected actor.

Licensing and display improvements

- Improved platform-neutral wording.

- Disabled access to Developer Tools through the normal app interface.
- Improved backstage display heartbeat status and recovery.
- Improved licence status and error messages.

v1.3

Licensing

Introduced Keygen licence activation, machine activation limits and offline licence validation.